

Indira Gandhi
National Open University
School of Continuing Education

COMMUNICATION AND EXTENSION IN RURAL DEVELOPMENT

**Discipline of Rural Development
School of Continuing Education
Indira Gandhi National Open University**

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March, 2023

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ISBN-

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Further Information on the Indira Gandhi National Open University courses may be obtained from the University's Office and Maidan Garhi, New Delhi-110068

Printed and Published on behalf of Indira Gandhi National Open University, New Delhi, by Registrar,
MPDD, IGNOU, New Delhi

Laser Composed by: M/s. Tessa Media & Computers, C-206, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi

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BLOCK 1
PRINCIPLES OF COMMUNICATION



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BLOCK 1 INTRODUCTION

Communication is a prerequisite for understanding and communicating about Rural Development in society. Hence, it is important to understand the principles of communication that may be used to connect and engage with Rural Development in society. Communication is the means through which the messages related to Rural Development may be circulated to larger society. Although these means of communications vary from interpersonal to mass media and at present more advanced forms of electronic media prevalent in society, however, each one of them have different characteristics and function. In this block an attempt has been made to introduce basic concept, principles, approaches and methods of communication. The Block consists of four units.

Unit-1 Concepts and theories of Communication aims to introduce you the basic concepts and theories of communication. It discusses the basic elements of communication and elaborates various types and classifications in communication. Communication is an essential and indeed the foundational part of the human existence. Without communication, there would be no constructive or purposive meaning of life, and consequently it becomes significant to understand the purposiveness of communication. Having a well-balanced knowledge of communication is considered as the pillar on which rest of the field rests. Theory is a way of looking or perspective towards things. This module intends to provide an overview of communication theories, that are being studied from different perspectives and facets.

Unit-2 is on Functions of Communication. In this unit, you will learn about the process and function of communication. It will give you an understanding about the role of communication in making society functional and identify the characteristics of communication that may be assigned the functional role to communication in society. Communication forms the core function of human existence. It is only through communication that that an individual feels belonged in any relationship and feels accepted at the society at large. Communication simply does not mean sending and receiving information or messages from one point to another but it is rather more than that and involves expressions and feelings as well. Individuals communicate with each other as members of a group, organisations and within larger social structure. No society can exist without communication, neither, communication can occur outside a social system or society.

Unit-3 Interpersonal Communication discusses about definition, process and elements of interpersonal communication. Interpersonal communication builds the connection between people. Such communication tends to affect people's action and reflect the other. Interpersonal communication has undergone massive changes with the advancements in information and communication technologies. Along with change, interpersonal communication too has appropriated and adopted the changed circumstance to remain dynamic, vibrant and influential in the communication. It is transactional as the participations in the process of communication are engaged in interaction. It tends to change and persuade participants'

behaviour and relationship. These dimensions are pervasive while strategizing interpersonal communication for rural development.

Unit-4 Electronic Media and Rural Development is aimed at acquainting students with the importance of electronic media and its role and contributions for Rural Development. The objective is to familiarize students about the potential of electronic media that may be used for developmental purpose. The focus is on various types of electronic media which are low cost, participatory and interactive. Electronic media is a significant force in facilitating development. The messages propagated through electronic media are governed by instantaneity and simultaneity. These two terms refer to message as instant in nature and reaches simultaneously to all at the same time. Rapid communication through latest media technologies has facilitated speedy information gathering and dissemination and this has become an essential part of the modern society. With the help of case studies, this unit explains the use of electronic media applications for Rural Development.



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UNIT 1 CONCEPTS AND THEORIES OF COMMUNICATION

Contents

- 1.1 Aims and Objectives
- 1.2 Introduction
- 1.3 Elements of Communication
- 1.4 Classification/ Forms of Communication
- 1.5 Communication Theories
- 1.6 Communication Models
- 1.7 Let Us Sum Up
- 1.8 Key Words
- 1.9 Suggested Readings
- 1.10 Answers to Check Your Progress

1.0 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

This unit presents the concepts and theories of communication and is intended to familiarize you with the communication process. It starts with elaboration of the concepts of communication followed by its' theories so that you can grasp every component of communication. We will discuss the basic elements of communication and will elaborately define its' various types and classifications. At the end of this unit, you would be able to –

- understand the concept and meaning of communication;
- explain the communication process;
- analyse the different forms of communication and the basics characteristics of each of them; and
- describe the different communication theories and models.

1.1 INTRODUCTION

Any field or discipline of study dealing with human behaviour or society at large is essentially concerned with understanding the process of communication. Interestingly, for understanding communication process, the element of social set up or society becomes an integral part this analysis.

Many definitions have been given by scholars for understanding Communication theories. Stephen Turner (1994) compares theories with stories about how and why events occur and that it begins with a hypothesis that the universe reveals several basic and fundamental properties and processes, which explain the flow of events in specific processes. Two other theorists, John Bowers and John Courtright (1984) propose a traditional

scientific definition which states that theories are basically statements asserting relationships among classes of variables.

In simpler words, communication is an essential and indeed the foundational part of the human existence. Without communication, there would be no constructive or purposive meaning of life, and consequently it becomes significant to understand the purposiveness of communication. Having a well-balanced knowledge of communication is considered as the pillar on which rest of the field rests. Theory is a way of looking or perspective towards things. Interestingly, there is much agreement and disagreement about what constitutes a suitable theory of communication, i.e., a theory of how the process of communication works. This module intends to provide an overview of communication theories, that are being studied from different perspectives and facets.

Theories are also described as wider arrays of ways for understanding the social and communicative world. Theories refer to the explanations and forecasts of social phenomena concerning to the subject of interest or the subject under study and also to some other phenomenon. Other scholars define theory as the organized set of concepts, descriptions and principles of certain aspect of human experience. In other words, a theory is described as an idea that elucidates an event or behaviour. It brings precision to an otherwise complex situation by drawing order out of chaos with putting emphasis on fundamental, and helps in ignoring that point which makes little difference otherwise. This module also deals with the historical influences on the theories and models that shaped the entire communication discipline.

Communication theory in everyday view is different from how scholars perceive it. From scholar's perspective, communication is described as a process by which people interact, sustain and manage. In summation, we can say that communication means conveying or sharing of information, knowledge, opinions, ideas, etc. It denotes the transmission of certain message from a source to a receiver. Interestingly, the process of communication also comprises all the actions through which one mind possesses the capacity of affecting another mind or entire human behaviour either orally or via written words.

1.2 ELEMENTS OF COMMUNICATION

The basic meaning of communication is clear by now from the above discussions that it is the process of sharing and exchanging of information, opinions, feelings or ideas. However, this earlier basic meaning has undergone many a changeover the years making the meaning more expanded as well as complicated. We will have a look at what the renowned scholars have put forward in terms of the definitions of communication. Wilbur Schramm (1971) stated that “communication is a process of conveying of feelings, ideas, knowledge and motivations from one mind to another, in a

way that the receiver remains as the passive agent in this entire process.” However, this concept of the passive audiences or listeners did not find any base as it was found that at times the audiences tend to refuse some of the messages what is thrown at them. Interestingly, it is the message that gets transmitted to the receiver and specifically not the ideas or the thoughts. The reception or perception part remains at the end of the receiver and many times the message may bring slight alteration in the behaviour of the receiver that might not have been intended on the part of the sender.

Theodorson and Theodorson (1969) conceived communication as a process of transmission of approaches, emotions and outlooks from a person or a group to another person or group mainly with the help of symbols. There are many discussions and deliberations regarding the meaning of communication. However, the meaning that we mainly derive from the above definitions is that ‘communication is a process of imparting and conveying of thoughts and knowledge from one mind to the other(s) through either oral or written form. In this process, the sender and the receiver communicate within some social context. Definitions given by other scholars like Rogers (1973) or Berelson and Steiner (1964) also resonate the same meaning that communication is the planned or unplanned process of transmitting information or ideas through which one person has the capacity or intend to influence the other person.

So, the above meanings help us in drawing the elements or components of communication. We have seen that we have a sender who produces and sends messages to the receiver in a timely and properly manner with the use of a channel for achieving certain goals. Thus, we can say that the concept of communication solely depends on four basic elements—encoding (sender), medium of transmission, decoding (receiver) and feedback. This process basically starts with a sender and finishes with a receiver. Let us now understand the relationship between the sender and the receiver in a communication process. For instance, if the communication skills of both sender and receiver are extremely good, the message will be encoded and decoded effectively. A given source might be having a higher level of skills that are not shared by the receiver, so we cannot simply foresee the success of the source or sender from its skill level only. It is generally the experiences, skills, attitudes, knowledge of the sender that influences the message and its subsequent impact on the receiver. So, in the encoding process, the sender has to start by deciding what message is to be transmitted. At times, the assumptions and perceived knowledge of the receiver or the targeted audience also plays a great role in framing of the message.

Communication theorist Schramm (1971) noted that “communication is the sharing of an orientation towards a set of informational signs.” Here, information refers not only to facts or news or whatever is taught in any classroom, but it also refers to any content that reduces uncertainty or the number of alternate possibilities in any given situation. It clearly includes opinions, facts, influence, emotions, and guidance communicated

appropriately. Hence we gather that the elements of communication are – sender, encoding, message, channel, decoding, receiver, feedback and noise or barrier.

1.3 CLASSIFICATION/ FORMS OF COMMUNICATION

There are numerous classifications or forms of communication but majorly it is divided into two major forms – ‘verbal communication’ and ‘non-verbal communication’.

Verbal communication includes –

- a) Oral communication – talking or conversing to oneself or others, some form of dialogue or discussion between two or more people, groups, etc.
- b) Visual communication – maps, graphic designs, posters, print advertisements, etc.
- c) Written communication – memorandums, reports, mails, etc.
- d) Communication via electronic or digital mode – communication enabled by digital/computing technologies such as laptops, emails, mobile phones, etc.

Oral Communication

When the information/idea/thought is transferred, shared or exchanged between sender and receiver by means of verbal and visual aid, it is called oral communication. In oral communication words are spoken for example while making presentations or delivering a speech by a politician or conducting a class by a professor. It is a very common and effective way to communicate. It is generally done face to face however, a telephonic conversation is also considered as oral communication. In oral communication the receiver not only receives spoken words but also non-verbal features like facial expressions, body movements etc.

Oral communication has the following three levels:

- **Person to person:** In such type of communication, the conversation is between two individuals. For example, communication between a shopkeeper and a customer or conversation between two friends is person to person communication.
- **Person to group:** In such type of communication, the communication is from a person to a group. For example, a classroom is a perfect example of person to group communication or the priest giving sermon in the church to a group of people.
- **Group to group:** In such type of communication, the communication is between two groups, for example, a debate between two teams.

Non Verbal Communication

The process of sending and receiving wordless messages is called non-verbal communication. In such communication, the participants exchange ideas and thoughts through gestures or touch, by exhibiting a particular body language or posture, by facial expressions and by making eye contact. Non-verbal communication is also called 'communication with implication'. It is necessary to understand that non-verbal communication is different from body language.

Interestingly, whatsoever the type of communication is, its objectives remain the same mostly.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Explain 'communication' and its importance in human lives.

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2) What are the different elements of communication?

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3) Which are the different forms of communication?

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1.4 COMMUNICATION THEORIES

After going through the reading on the meaning, process and the forms of communication, we will now focus on the different theories of communication. As mentioned earlier, theories provide a systematic understanding of the

process of communication and its' relevance in the social structure. We need to have an understanding of the various aspects of the theories to gather relevant viewpoints of the discipline of communication and its relevance.

I) Classical Theories

a) Authoritarian Theory

This theory suggests that mass media have to follow the command of the State even though it is not directly under the State's control. Authoritarian theory endorsed enthusiastic obedience to a classified superiority and advocated threat and penalty for those not following the rules set out by the supreme authority. This theory also justified censorship on the grounds that the State stands superior over the right and freedom of expression of an individual. The Authoritarian theory developed after the invention of the printing press by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440 in Strasburg Germany. This theory evolved during the 16th and 17th century. The Authoritarian theory considers citizens as inferior or subservient to the state. The theory holds a belief that the rich, powerful, elites and the rulers are authorised to lead the masses. Therefore, all information to be disseminated by the mass media must be the interpretation of the powerful, rich and elites of the society. According to this theory, the masses are incapable of making interpretations and therefore they should be led. The press or mass media is considered as the tool or weapon of the powerful and the rich to communicate what they deem as correct. There is no provision of public dissent or the mass is not permitted to reject what is being communicated by the state. This theory basically follows a top – down approach of communication. The social reality is constructed by the mass media according to the notions, ideas and judgements of the elites. The state determines its objectives and then uses the press to achieve them. The mass media is used to make believe that the state is correct. The press is used to create a favourable and desirable image of the state. According to the authoritarian theory, the government exerts pressure on mass media forcing it to publish/broadcast information in favour of the government. Even though mass media is an independent body, it still faces an unseen pressure from the authority. The idea of censorship is announced by the authoritarian theory. Censorship is “the suppression or prohibition of any parts of books, films, news etc. that are considered obscene, politically unacceptable, or a threat to security.” It is observed that media organizations that publish in favour of the government, receives licenses and advertisements and media houses which are critical of the government receive backlash and curtailment of publishing rights.

b) Free Press Theory or Libertarian Theory

This theory is based on the idea of the basic individual right and supports the absence of limitation in the expression of one's thoughts. The foundation of this theory dates back to 17th century in England when the

State was considered as a main source of intrusion on the rights and personal properties of an individual. Libertarians debated that the press should be perceived as the *Fourth Estate* with the power for reflecting larger public opinion. Libertarian theory has its roots back in the sixteenth century Europe. This era was characterised by the aristocratic control over the common people. This theory opposed the authoritarian concept and emerged because of social and political movements like the Protestant Reformation. The practitioners of Libertarian theory were against the practice of governing elites controlling the freedom of the press. They did not approve of the authorities justifying their control as a technique to protect the state and maintain social order. There were several instances where the King granted licenses and permissions to media practitioners and if the media practitioners were found to violate the orders of the king, they could be imprisoned or their licenses could be revoked. Early Libertarians argued that “if individuals could be freed from the arbitrary limits on communication imposed by church and state, they would ‘naturally’ follow the dictates of their conscience, seek truth, engage in public debate, and ultimately create a better life for themselves and others (McQuail, 1987; Siebert, Peterson, and Schramm, 1956).”

c) **Social Responsibility Theory**

The critics of Free Press Theory advocated for the need of its replacement by Social Responsibility theory, which supported responsibility on the part of the mass media towards the larger society. It believed in the idea that the advent of popular mass media like the television, radio or films need to owe some levels of accountability. Thus, this theory became the modern variant promoting the idea that one's morality was the prime basis of the right of free expression and speech. During the World War II, there was a greater need for government regulation of media and the demand continued during the anti-communist agitation that followed.

II) **Magic Bullet/ Hypodermic Needle Theory**

According to this theory, mass media constructs a message which is targeted to a certain audience. This message is transmitted just like how a gun triggers a bullet and the message is received by the audience who are like sitting ducks and lack the wisdom to interpret or challenge the message. It is by sending the message through mass media to the audience the desired response is achieved. The message transmitted by mass media has direct effect on the minds of the audience and they most certainly believe in the message. This theory advocated the outlook that mass media has a strong influence on the audiences and it can easily alter or mould peoples' behaviour as it considered the audiences to be passive. One of the major factors considered accountable for the strong effects of mass media is selective exposure that talks about the tendency of people of exposing themselves to content that are largely in agreement with their

interests and beliefs. The second factor is selective perception and selective retention, which indicates towards the inclination of people to perceive the meaning of media messages in accordance with their already prevailing thoughts.

III) One Step, Two Step and Multi Step Flow Theory

One step flow theory suggests that mass media directly communicate with the audiences minus the filtration of message by opinion leaders whereas two step flow theory suggests the reverse. It indicates towards the flow of information from mass media to opinion leaders and from there to the audiences. It talks about the influence that the informal social groups or opinion leaders have on people and how capable they are in moulding the way the audiences select the media content and react to it. Multi step flow theory suggests something similar. It talks about several interferences or relays in the flow of communication from the sender/source to the audiences.

IV) Spiral of Silence Theory

This theory basically explains the process of public opinion formation. According to this theory, spiral of silence is the process experienced by an individual when, “he may find that the views he holds are losing ground; the more this appears to be so, the more uncertain he will become of himself, and the less he will be inclined to express his opinions.” In other words, this particular theory points that mass media advertises views that are main-stream and audiences adjust their views as per to their insights to avoid being secluded. Individuals who foresee their opinion as being acknowledged will openly express it, whereas those who contemplate themselves as being marginal in terms of being accepted will suppress their views and remain side-lined.

V) Uses and Gratification Theory

This particular theory is mainly interested in finding out how people use media for fulfilling their needs. This theory advocates the fact that individuals select their content from the media to satisfy their needs and derive gratification accordingly. It signifies that an individual use media for various purposes and this approach further suggests that audiences acquire different kinds of gratifications. This theory was proposed by Elihu Katz in 1959. This theory is a shift of thought from how media uses people to how people use media. The question which strikes the mind is that what do people do with the media? The answer to this question is that people receive information, knowledge, awareness, education, entertainment from the media. Unlike mass media theories which emphasises on the media influence and impact, the Uses and Gratification theory explores the motives on the basis of which people use media and how gratifications are obtained. Unlike the hypodermic needle theory which considers audience to be incapable of judgment and

passive, uses and gratification theory highlights how positive motivation and active use of media content can gratify the needs of the receiver.

VI) Cultivation Theory

Cultivation theory of Mass Media was conceptualised by George Gerbner in the 1960s and 1970s. The theory is also referred to as the 'cultivation hypothesis' or 'cultivation analysis'. Cultivation theory attempts to study the long-term effects of Television (TV) on viewers. The theory asserts that "the danger of television lies in its ability to shape not a particular view point about on specific issue but in its ability to shape people's moral values and general beliefs about the world." Cultivation theory lies in the "effects tradition" and the cultivations theorists argue that "television has long-term effects which are small, gradual, indirect but cumulative and significant." Cultivation theory in its basic form, suggests that television is responsible for shaping or cultivating viewers conceptions of social reality. The combined effect of massive television exposure by viewers over time subtly shapes the perception of social reality for individuals and ultimately for our culture as a whole. Gerbner argues that the mass media cultivate attitudes and values which are already present in a culture: the media maintain and propagate these values amongst members of a culture, thus binding it together. He has argued that television tends to cultivate middle-of-the-road political perspectives. Gerbner called this effect "mainstreaming."

VII) Media Dependency Theory

This theory propagated the idea that people mostly depend on information provided by the media for meeting their needs and certain goals. Further, this theory suggests that social institutions along with media interact with the audiences and create interests and needs of certain level. The theory studies the interrelations of larger social systems, mass media and the individual as a result of effect of mass media. The concept is based on the simple assumption that the more an individual depends upon mass media to fulfil her/his needs; the dependency on media will grow making it more important in the person's life. The theory suggests that in a modern society, media is considered as an essential 'information system' required for the maintenance, change and conflict processes at the societal, group or individual levels of social action. The theory emphasizes that in such a society, individuals heavily depend on mass media information for knowing what is happening in their own society.

VIII) Agenda Setting Theory

Agenda setting theory explains how mass media has the potential to set agenda for the people. The theory explains that mass media is an influential tool which has the ability to tell the people what issues are significant and requires attention of the public and the policy makers.

According to the theory, mass media tries to influence the people and list news items on the basis of preference received by them. Agenda setting helps in creating public awareness about important issues as perceived by people.

The researchers have two basic assumptions which lay the foundation of agenda setting – *firstly*, the press and the media does not reflect reality, they only filter and shape it and *secondly*, the media concentrates on certain issues which are perceived by the people as most important. A significant aspect of this theory is the “time frame” required for this phenomenon which is why different media have different agenda-setting.

The theories mentioned above suggest that the primary purpose of the role of communication in any form is to maintain balance within the social system. The bottom line derived out of these theories is that communication definitely serves diverse purposes and it is also the means of maintaining relationship between people within the society.

1.6 MODELS OF COMMUNICATION

We have elaborately discussed the major theories of communication. We have developed an understanding that the study of communication is essentially multi-disciplinary that draws concepts from different disciplines like that of sociology, psychology, political science, etc. Now, we need to understand what is meant by a communication model. A model is defined as a methodical representation of an object or occurrence in perfect as well as abstract form. Further, the act of conceptualizing rejects certain details in order to focus on critical factors. In the communication process, a model proposes framework on the basis of which it becomes easier and convenient to identify and address the problems encountered during the process of communication. A model must clarify and simplify the structure of communication and must offer new dimensions to it in a graphic form. There are several advantages of communication models — models perform an organising function by placing the elements of communication process in a specific order and also recommend the association between them. Moreover, communication models offer explanations to complex or vague concepts and they also help in listing possible outcomes or suggest sequence of an event.

Types of Models: Linear, Transactional and Interactional.

I) The Key Features of Linear Models are –

- One way communication
- Used in mass communication
- Sender sends the information and receiver only receive
- No feedback
- No mention of possibility of noise or barrier

- Effective persuasive tool
- Desired results are obtained
- No proper way to determine the effectiveness of communication as no feedback is recorded
- Not a continuous process.

Some examples of linear models of communication are Aristotle's model of communication, Shannon and Weaver, Harold D. Laswell's model of communication. We will elaborately discuss few models here.

Aristotle's model: This model was based in oral communication and is known as Aristotelian model of communication. The model is considered the oldest model of communication and dates back to 300 BC. According to the model, the speaker is most central to communication process and is the most important element. Speaker is the only active element who delivers the message as a speech to an audience at a particular occasion and generates an effect, mostly a positive one. The audience is the passive target audience who is expected to get influenced by the speech. It is therefore, a one way flow of communication from the sender to the receiver.

The speaker prepares the speech according to the occasion and the target audience. The speaker pre-determines the desired effect and accordingly the speech is carefully drafted to meet the objectives of the speaker. It is necessary to prepare the speech in a way that it is best understood and accepted by the target audience. The speaker must keep in mind the selection of language, cultural beliefs, needs and attitudes of the audience. The speech must be persuasive and influential. It is interesting to note that as per this model communication does generate an effect but does not facilitate feedback and leaves the audience influenced without participating in the process. The model is primarily used in public speaking and to create propaganda. It is also noteworthy that even if audience does not provide feedback, the communication process focuses on the receivers. The most basic example of this model is an election campaign, during which the politician (speaker) addresses (speech) the people of his/her constituency (target audience) during the elections (occasion) and wins support (effect). If the candidate wins the election, it is a result of the influence and propaganda spread by delivering the speech.

Shannon and Weaver Model: This model aims at facilitating communication between the sender and the receiver by identifying factors that can hinder the process, such an obstacle is called "noise". The model was primarily developed to improve telephonic communication and was later applied to communication discipline. The model proposed six elements of a communication process — source, encoder, message, medium/ channel, decoder, and receiver. The model was produced in 1949. The model gave importance to the transmission and reception of information. The model was a linear model and ignored feedback in the communication process.

According to this model, the sender is the source of information or information source who selects the channel and transfers the message. Encoder is the transmitter or a machine which converts the messages into signal in the form of binary data. Channel is the medium used to transmit the information. Decoder is the machine used to decode the information received and the signal in the form of binary data is decoded. Receiver is the person who finally gets the message. Noise is the disturbance that does not permit smooth communication between the sender and the receiver. Shannon and Weaver were the first ones to point out 'Noise' in the communication process. It is extremely important to identify noise or disturbance for carrying out smooth communication. This model is a two way flow of communication. It can be applied to interpersonal communication primarily however, in the new media age, it is applicable to group communication as well for example, a conference call, group chats on social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter and WhatsApp involves more than two participants.

This model was criticised for emphasising on a passive receiver as the sender plays a dominant role in the process. Feedback is considered less important than the message sent by the sender. As per this model, communication within a medium is often unidirectional and direct; however in the real media world communication is rarely unidirectional and is mostly indirect.

Harold D. Lasswell's model: Harold D. Lasswell was a political scientist who studied the American presidential elections of 1948. He studied propaganda and analysed political campaigning and introduced a linear model. The model is also known as the Action model. The model was published in an article titled, "The Structure and Function of Communication in Society" in 1948 and according to this model there are five components of a communication process. The process begins with identifying who (the sender) is sending what (message) through what channel (medium) to whom (receiver) with what effect (feedback). Lasswell's model is the traditional way of doing propaganda. It is a way to study media effects. The model does not mention noise or barriers of communication; it also ignores honest feedback as the effect is pre-determined.

II) Key Features of Transactional Models are –

- Used for interpersonal communication
- Sender and receiver are participants with interchangeable roles
- Provision for simultaneous feedback
- Includes the content of environment and noise
- Feedback is considered as a fresh message.

Example of transactional models — Helical Model, Gate Keeping Model

Helical Model of Communication or Dance Model: This model was introduced in 1967 by an American Communication Professor, Frank E.X. Dance. It is popularly known as Dance's model of communication. This

model is inspired by a spiral or helix which is a three dimensional spring like curve in the shape of a cylinder or a cone. Dance compared the helix with human communication. The process of communication is non-linear and evolutionary as the helix grows bigger, so does human communication. In the beginning of communication between two people, the participants in the beginning share less information about themselves. It is only gradually after spending time with each other and based on the experience they have had, communication increases and evolves. Therefore, according to Dance, communication is a dynamic process, which is ever-changing, never-ending and ever-growing with time and past experiences. It is slow and less at the beginning and grows upward with time. The model suggests that the sender and receiver have interchangeable roles which make it a dyadic process. This model considers intellect and speculation as important factors which affect communication.

Gate Keeping Model: Kurt Lewin, a German social psychologist, conceptualised the term Gate Keeping in 1943. The concept was developed for mass communication and transmission of news by David Manning White. Gate keeping is the process of selection of information according to importance and relevance. The information is also published according to the amount of importance the media wants the information to have. It is the gatekeeper who decides to filter information and selects what needs to be transferred to the audience. Through this process, the unwanted, irrelevant and prejudiced items are weeded out by the gatekeeper. For example, in a family set up, a mother decides what is important for the children and what is not. Similarly, in the news business, the editor plays the role of a gatekeeper who decides what news items to publish and which ones to reject or discard.

Limited space or time can affect the number of items selected for a specific news bulletin or a newspaper edition. The fundamental function of a gatekeeper is surveillance; the editor keeps a check on the information flow and determines what is most important for the organization as well as the audience. Gate keeping also maintains the standard of news by selecting newsworthy items. It is possible that the editor or the gatekeeper will bring changes to the news item received by the reporter because of subjective perceptions. Media plays the role of a watchdog of the society and must be responsible while deciding the news content. The concept is used as a social controller for media influence.

III) Key Features of Intersectional Models are –

- Used for new communications like internet
- Slower feedback
- Facilitates convergence
- Includes field of experience
- Communication can turn linear if feedback is not received

Wilbur Schramm's interactive model is one good example of intersectional model.

Wilbur Schramm's Model of Communication: Wilbur Lang Schramm, a communication scholar, expanded the Shannon and Weaver's communication model in 1954. He emphasised on the process of encoding and decoding of the message. Schramm suggested that communication is a two-circular process between the sender and the receiver. To the six elements of communication introduced by Shannon and Weaver, Schramm included two other elements, namely – Feedback and Field of Experience.

Feedback is the information which is sent back to the sender by the receiver. It signals the effectiveness of the message and suggests whether the message was properly interpreted by the receiver or not. Feedback plays a crucial role in determining the success of the communication. On the other hand, Schramm introduced an imaginary area which is a part of the communicator's mental and social construct. It contains the individual's values, beliefs, experiences and meanings. If the sender and the receiver do not share the common field of experience, communication will not be successful. According to Schramm, messages can be interpreted differently by different people thereby, making the communication process difficult. The interpretation of the message plays key role in determining how well it has been communication. The interpretation can be denotative or connotative. Denotative meanings are literal meanings of the words being spoken and connotative meanings are emotional or experiential attributions attached to the words. To have a successful communication, it is important for the sender and receiver to share common field of experience. Schramm believed that people make decisions based on the information they receive about their society and environment.

Communication models lead us to a common understanding of the phenomena of communication and each model is contributing to the learning process evolving from that understanding. There ought to be arguments about which of these concepts is absolutely appropriate, but eventually we find cohesion by appreciating the multiplicity of diverse methods and the scholarship, which they have produced.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Name the major theories of communication.

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2) What do you understand by a communication model?

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1.6 LET US SUM UP

In this unit, we have discussed and understood the meaning and concepts of communication. We have familiarized with the process of communication and how it starts with a sender giving a message through a medium to the receiver. We have also gathered that communication takes place at different phases. The basic objective of communication is to cater a message with a meaning; however the perception of the message depends entirely on the part of the receiver. We need to have this clarification that meaning is not the same as that of the content or the message, because as stated earlier a single message can be decoded in multiple ways as perceived by the audiences. Communication helps in developing connections between people through different forms or media. The theories of communication give us an idea that communication has always been a social activity and it is a subject of constant research by scholars, theorists or educationists. Thus, this unit has explained the key concepts, meaning and different theories associated with communication that help us in formulating a strong base of our understanding about the subject. So, we can sum up with the statement that communication forms relationships and makes organizing groups possible. Every message in the communication process has a resolution or objective. The sender definitely intends either intentionally or unintentionally to wards accomplishing something by communicating. Communication does not begin when an individual starts to speak. It begins with the individual responding selectively to his physical surroundings. It can be said that the process of communication begins when message is received from the surroundings and the individual reacts on the basis of his/ her object of orientation.

1.7 KEYWORDS

Communication: Communication is a process that establishes relationships and makes organizing and coordination possible. The term has been derived from the Latin word ‘communis’, which means having something in common.

Sender: The person who wants to transfer, exchange or share the information is called sender.

Message: The encoded content/idea/information which is transferred or shared by the sender is called Message.

Channel: The medium through which the message is transmitted to the receiver is known as Channel.

Receiver: Receiver is the person to whom the message is directed.

Feedback: The response of the receiver sent back to the sender after decoding the message is called feedback.

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1.9 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) Communication is a process that establishes relationships and makes organizing and coordination possible. In communication process, every message has a purpose and objective. Communication is a process that establishes relationships and makes organizing and coordination possible. The need for communication for a human being is as strong and as basic as the need to eat, sleep and live. It is both an individual and a social need. Communication can raise aspirations and raise awareness, meet information needs, and reinforce existing beliefs. We all communicate in some form or the other. We communicate to express our happiness, sadness, opinions, etc.
- 2) Communication is made possible through different components and these are sender, encoding, message, channel, decoding, receiver, feedback and noise or barrier.
- 3) The major forms of communication are non-verbal communication and verbal communication. Non-verbal communication including facial

expression, body language or silence. Verbal communication includes oral and written communication.

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) The major theories of communication are Authoritarian Theory, Free Press Theory or Libertarian Theory, Social Responsibility Theory, Magic Bullet or Hypodermic Needle Theory, One Step, Two Step and Multi Step Flow Theory, Spiral of Silence Theory, Uses and Gratification Theory, Cultivation Theory, Media Dependency Theory and Agenda Setting Theory.
- 2) In the communication process, a model suggests framework on the basis of which problems encountered during the process of communication can be identified and addressed. A model must clarify and simplify the structure of communication and must offer new dimensions to it in a graphic form.

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UNIT 2 FUNCTIONS OF COMMUNICATION

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- 2.0 Aims and Objectives
- 2.1 Introduction
- 2.2 Communication – Process
- 2.3 Functions of Communication
- 2.4 Importance of Communication
- 2.5 Principles of Communication
- 2.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 2.7 Suggested Readings
- 2.8 Answers to Check Your Progress

2.0 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

In this unit, you will learn about the process and function of communication. The present unit will give you an understanding about the role of communication in making society functional and identify the characteristics of communication that may be assigned the functional role to communication in society. At the end of this unit, you would be able to:

- Understand the functions of communication;
- Describe the characteristics of communication that makes society functional;
- Analyse the significance of communication and its various elements; and
- Explain the scope of communication.

2.1 INTRODUCTION

We are aware that as being a part of the society, we are required to establish relationships with other people, groups, and larger institutions. In its simplest form communication forms the core function of human existence. It is only through communication that that an individual feels belonged in any relationship and feels accepted at the society at large. We understand that communication simply does not meansending and receiving information or messages from one point to another but it is rather more than that and involves expressions and feelings as well. Individuals communicate with each other. They may also communicate with others as members of a group. Individuals also communicate with organisations and within larger social structure.

Hence, no society can exist without communication, neither, communication can occur outside a social system or society. The early thinkers put emphasis

on the role of personal communication in this 'binding together' process. Denis McQuail suggests that 'commonality' plays a key role in the process of communication. Common set of symbols, common language, common culture etc. makes the process easy. According to McQuail, "communication is the process which increases commonality — but also requires elements of commonality for it to occur at all." Common interests and occurrences help people to come together and exchange ideas.

But the later generations put emphasis on the innovations in mass communication such as in mass media as a means of facilitating the communication process. Communication also affects the values and attitudes of those who use them and, in turn, the values and attitudes of these users influence mass to a social nexus.

The 'new look' in mass communications, as put forth by Joseph T. Klapper and Riley focuses on the mediating roles of other psychological and sociological factors in influencing the impacts that the mass media can produce on individuals and groups. This new look emerges directly out of Thomas' conceptual framework as illustrated by this quotation from Klapper:

"The new orientation (to the study of the media's effects) . . . is in essence a shift away from the tendency to regard mass communication as a necessary and sufficient cause of audience effects, toward a view of the media as influences working amid other influences in a total situation. The old quest of specific effects stemming from the communications has given way to the observation of existing conditions or changes, followed by an inquiry into the factors, including mass communication, which produced those conditions and changes, and the roles which these factors played relative to each other. In short, attempts to assess a stimulus which was presumed to work alone have given way to an assessment of the role of that stimulus in a total observed phenomenon."

Essentially, this has been the keystone of the approach developed by Lazarsfeld, Berelson, Pool, Lasswell, etc., who have been interested in how primary group organization determines the way in which messages are transmitted from source to recipient. In attempting an overview of the sociological impact on mass communication, the effect tradition can be assessed from the communication studies concerned with the study of human behaviour, emotions, attitudes and knowledgeability. This tradition shared the social sciences' particular vision of scientific enquiry based on the interconnection of theory, hypothesis and experiment. The central argument in this tradition is that communication has its effects which show up empirically in terms of a direct influence on individuals. Communication studies in this paradigm presuppose the values of individualism and operate on the strength of efficiency and instrumental value. Most scholars make distinctions between the structures of processes of human social systems from the structure created strictly by humans (i.e., technology).

Scholars have endeavoured to demonstrate these complications diagrammatically. The skeleton provided by the original model is Source/Receiver (S-R). It was used further by behavioural psychology as Stimulus-Response; both cases involved an assumption that human social behaviour can be adequately explained in terms of independent, environmentally isolated, discrete social chains. In fact, more conceptual components have been added to the original assumptions. Thus, the Stimulus-Response model has enjoyed a quasi-hegemonic existence. The growing interest in socialization and construction of a social reality provides another significant challenge to the static behavioural model of communication.

Studies in social identity extend the concern with the construction of social reality to include more of the external influences found in the social structure, and make an explicit attempt to tie together internal and external processes at different levels of analysis. Most of these scholars explicate socialization as a process of integrating individuals into larger legitimate social structures. Legitimation — a way of explaining and justifying a given actual structure and ideas that support it — helps to reify that role structure by preventing people from recognizing the conventional (that is, not natural) basis of such a social creation.

Consequently, communication research delves into the relationship among individuals, investigates questions of social identity and, broadly speaking, raises some doubts about the stability of individuals in their social relations. At the same time, however, there is a marked absence of investigating the structure of society, the location of authority and the distribution and transmission of power, as well as a lack of articulation of larger, more fundamental questions about the failure of the functionalist vision of the social whole, including the failure of its own theoretical and conceptual foundation. Although reform minded, in the sense of understanding itself as contributing to the betterment of society, communication research remains committed to a traditionally conservative approach to the study of social and cultural phenomena in which instrumental values merge and identify with moral values. This position tends to consider mediated, conditioned, effect variables to be more informative than overt decision-making behaviours. Also, non-decision-making, or the exercise of power through the suppression of interests as in gatekeeping', is important in itself. It extends the concept of communication to include less visible forms. Usually operating at the individual level of social analysis, this position tends to seek most of its evidence in observable (directly or indirectly) conflict and behaviour. A host of studies assume the apriori existence of open, rational, informed debate and tend to prefer a vision of communication consistent with the ideals of participatory democracy. The scholars working with such a vision are concerned with the integrative functions of media. This integrative orientation in the functional approach is particularly evident in uses and gratification research, which has remained a popular approach over the years in communication studies. Such research uses communication to help explain

connections between individuals and social environment. Similarly, Goode had long criticized the functionalist perspective for its conservative view that forces are static, and for ignoring the extent to which the larger social system of alternatives and opportunities has actually inhibited or prevented people from behaving as they otherwise might have. This restriction of opportunity tends to maintain and reproduce the existing structure of power and functionalism is not able to provide a critique of existing communication structures within society. In general, the functionalist perspective is criticized for neglecting process, historical change and conflict. It prefers a rather one-sided, optimistic view of society as an exclusively positive force with its individual elements working autonomously but cooperatively for the benefit and enhancement of the system. Further, functionalism is criticized for its lack of theoretical explanation in its common use as a descriptive analytic tool. Functionalist sociology has made us too accustomed to viewing the study of effects within a therapeutic and operational context because any disfunctioning of a means of communication is established within a therapeutic and operational context because any disfunctioning of a means of communication is established by its potential danger to the balance of the existing social forces and never by any dynamic qualities, which might engender another system. Another difficulty with such analysis is that it does not perceive the possibility of rupture within the system. Thomas argues that the functional perspective entails technical and mechanical reasoning in its presumption of system stability or the trend toward the maintenance of system equilibrium. There is an emphasis on functional unity and activism within the system, which is seen as functional equivalence for every individual's lot in society is in his or her own hands. It thus obscures the roles of communication played out through organizational, institutional and social arrangements. Elliott notes similar problems in uses and gratifications research, arguing that it has all the problems associated with functionalism and more because it is a highly individualistic version of social theory. The 'uses and gratifications' approach treats communication as an isolated process, somehow autonomous from the larger social context. It considers how media gratifies basic human needs (or functions for society as a whole) while considering neither the source of those needs nor the differential distribution of power and social opportunity. Since needs develop within the existing social structure, the 'uses and gratifications' approach based on identifying and describing needs inevitably tends to support the existing structure. This approach assumes an aware and active audience that cannot only make and report its choices, but also identify its reasons for those choices. Politically, such an assumption could provide justification for an existing system as neither communication content nor its production need to be questioned or subjected to critical policy decisions — after all the audience can take care of itself. Studies on communication interaction resulting in changes in social structure, communication patterns and culture shift the focus of communication as social control to communication as integral to socio-cultural change.

2.2 COMMUNICATION PROCESS

We have seen in the introduction that communication is the constantly changing dynamic function of exchanging information and subsequent interaction. Communication as a process involves at least two people minimum. The process begins when the sender has the desire to share or transfer information to the receiver. Sender encodes the message by converting the mental images into symbols which can be understood by the receiver. Symbols are mostly words but they can also be pictures/visuals and sound. This process of translating images into symbols is called encoding. The next step is transmitting the message to the receiver. Transmission of the encoded message can be done in several ways like face to face interaction, telephonic conversation, through printed/written documents or through visual media like photographs and videos. The most common communication channels include, verbal, written and visual media however, other transmission channels like touch, gestures, physical distance between sender and receiver are also used.

After the message is transmitted to the receiver, the message is decoded. The receiver decodes and interprets the symbols/information back into images, emotions and thoughts as per his or her sensibilities. When the message is decoded exactly as the sender has intended, the communication is perceived as effective. It is important to note that the process of communication is dynamic and involves feedback. Hence, the participants are both sender and receiver and their roles are interchangeable.

Thus, we learn that the process of communication begins when the sender encodes the message. After which the message is transferred through a channel or medium to the receiver who decodes the message and provides the feedback to the sender. The process is only successful if there is common field of experience between the sender and the receiver. In order to successfully complete the process, both the communicators (participants) must share common attitude, language, belief and interest. Common interpretation of a gesture will result in successful communication. Mutually accepted code e.g. common language by both the sender and the receiver is necessary. The context in which the communication takes place contains equal relevance and it is aptly referred as communication environment. The encoded message or the content is sent to the receiver in a certain medium that could be oral, written, signs or gesture using channels like air, body, audio, visual or text. The code is not limited to language; it may also involve the use of colours, costumes, gestures, etc. In simpler words, in the process of communication, the sender sends a message using a channel or a medium to the sensory world of the receiver who filters the message on the basis of her/his knowledge, emotions, perception, choice, attitude and prejudices and decodes the message. The decoded message has a unique meaning which triggers a response in the mind of the receiver. The receiver further encodes the response and sends the feedback into the physical world of the sender.

This is marked as one complete cycle of the communication process which continues in a cyclic manner as long as the participants (sender and receiver) are interested.

It is important to note that paying attention to what is being communicated is one of the most important aspects of communication. Active listening is essential for effective communication. If the listener is engrossed in the inner chatter, a lot of crucial information is lost. Therefore, it is significant to pay attention to the sender. It is also disrespectful to not listen to somebody. Listening to partial information can be very dangerous. Communication must be developed on trust and honesty. Mutual respect for both the participants in the communication process is very important. Trust is the foundation of each successful communication. Valid and accurate information helps in trustworthy communication. It is necessary to maintain the authenticity of the communication message. Inaccuracy, lies, deceit, confusion and incorrectness in the communication process can hamper it. Participants cannot be fooled by incorrect and unauthentic information. The words and body language should be in sync. If the body language is not appropriate, communication will fail.

Lastly, it is important to value the contribution of each participant involved in the communication process. Acknowledging the participant's efforts and inputs can create comfortable environment and effortless communication can take place. If the participants are respected and listened to, they will indulge in free and effective communication. Participants must be motivated and encouraged to share their opinions and ideas.

2.3 FUNCTIONS OF COMMUNICATION

It is being deliberated upon by communication research scholars that why people use media, for what specific purpose, and with what outcomes. Hence, what we can say here is that from a functionalist approach communication theorists are precisely interested in exploring the media effects on individuals and on the society at large. 'Functionalism' is considered as a theoretic perspective that majorly focuses on the functions performed by social institutions and structures contributing to the larger society. So, now within this larger perspective, the term 'function' denotes the level at which a given activity or action that either promotes or impedes with the maintenance of any system. Functionalist theory was believed to have developed during a time when the mass media was considered to have great power to influence the society. It is being argued by many theorists that mass media that is designed to reach the masses have somehow lost some of this influence over the years. We have understood in the above paragraphs how the process of mass communication takes place and that it does not necessarily always include linear, causal relationships, and this is specifically evident since the introduction of new forms or methods of communication that allow individuals to create their own channels and subsequently their own environments where they engage in communicating and interacting. So, what

we gather is functionalism emerged in the early 20th century and is associated with authors such as Émile Durkheim, Herbert Spencer, Robert Merton and Talcott Parsons, who ruled American social theory between the 1950s and 1960s. Here we get a focus on the implementation of functionalist theory to the study of mass communication. The scholars (Merton and Lazarsfeld) have identified three conventional functions of mass media in any society –

- status conferral
- enforcement of social norms
- narcotization

It is opined that much exposure to abundance of information leads to the idea that media has the potential to influence the audiences by turning their role as passive. Hence, this notion refers to the idea of ‘Narcotization’ and this idea is somewhat dysfunctional as it is not in the interest of a modern society to have majority of its population be politically indifferent or polarized. The larger exposure to the abundant pool of information does not positively energize the audiences as the more time they spend reading and listening, quite evitable the lesser time they get for the much needed organized action.

It is said that ‘status conferral’ basically occurs when a group’s or for that matter person’s prestige is enhanced because of excessive coverage by the mass media. By the concept ‘enforcement of social norms’, it is referred that by making deviances from social norms largely known to the public, the media influences people to decide whether the behaviour was right or wrong and hence in doing so it does underline the existing group norms. Besides this, there is another conventional categorization within the functionalist theory applicable to the study of mass media that is proposed by Merton who differentiates between dormant and obvious functions. The obvious functions have intended values for some person or a subgroup, or the entire socio-cultural systems causative to its adjustment, while latent or the dormant functions contribute to adjustment without being planned.

Harold Lasswell defined two functions of the mass media and these are ‘surveillance’ and ‘correlation’. Surveillance implies to the media keeping a track of events and identifying news stories that are worthy of attention, which is in other words described as ‘gatekeeping’. Lasswell’s (1948) idea of the “*correlation of the parts of society in responding to the environment*” draws an interesting similarity among a biological organism and society in the way where both strive to be in sync with the larger environment. Lasswell further illustrates the connection between the media and the public policy and its makers, letting them to understand and react accordingly to these issues.

More research is required in this area to demystify the dominance of behaviourism in communication research. Critics of behaviourism have not only argued that its research methods are unscientific, but that these impose overtly simplistic and narrow ways of thinking about the relation between the

environment and the individual. On the one hand, communication's effects are formulated in psycho behavioural terms in ways which believe the complexity of human experience; on the other, communication, as part of the environment, is treated in isolation and in terms of stimulus properties, which again distort its complexity. The dynamic interpretations of need, motivation, intent, values, interest and so on relevant to the interpretation of experience must figure in any attempt to understand communication exercises over people. The methods of behaviourism are unable to grasp more complex communication — people-society relationships—and it is primarily for this reason that scholars of communication turn towards critical theory for a more adequate understanding of communication. What is peculiar to behaviourist research on effects of communication is not so much the particular kind of effects studied, but the scientific methods and related techniques used. Researchers employing these methods are convinced that they are producing evidence about the consequences of communication. The conviction is based upon the assumption that only scientific research methods and techniques are capable of discovering realities about communication. The evidence comes in a scientific mantle which believes the unscientific manner in which it has been produced. At each stage in the production of scientific knowledge, via the methods of behaviourist psychology, the researcher draws objective inferences. The observed differences between experimental and control groups are made by means of psychological and behavioural measures which actually evaluate the relevant psychological variable in question.

The inferences which are routinely structured into behaviouristic methods, and which are intended to produce scientific evidence, are the products of an underlying theoretical behaviourism itself. Further, evidence obtained is used to give scientific credibility to the researcher's theoretical ideas, thus raising the status of these ideas above mere speculation. At the broader level, communication is held to be largely reflective or expressive of an achieved consensus. It raises questions concerning the social role and responsibility of media where it simply reproduces those cling uncritically to Lazarsfeld's 'limited effects' thesis. This thesis implicitly assigns ultimate responsibility for individual political behaviour to the individual since communication merely reinforces predispositions to behave at first a merely reinforcing role has now to be reconceptualized in terms of communication's role in the process of consensus formation. The quest for neutral objectivity in the study of social beings is a corollary of the scientific approach to social affairs. An analytic reductionism necessarily takes place in the process of this positivist approach. Such scientific studies propose that man should be manipulated in the service of a system, which treats them mechanically. As a result, most of the contemporary mainstream work in communication is critiqued for continuing to cling to a functionalist orientation of communication.

In this module, we will also discuss the significance of the mass media in cultural transmission, communicating the norms, rules, and values of different society from one generation to the other. Apart from the

aforementioned functions given by scholars there are other common yet significant functions associated with communication as communication is one topic that is studied and used in several disciplines such as management, industry, education, extension, public relations, advertising, radio, TV, films, etc. One of the chief functions of communication (at the human level) is to establish, maintain, explain or alter the relationship of a person with another. The other functions of communication are: (1) Information, (2) Motivation (3) Persuasion, (4) Integrative function, and (5) Entertainment function.

Information: Communication may be done for the purpose of transferring information. We are aware that information constitutes the basic element of adapting one's self to the environment or adapting the environment to oneself. In this case, the information is encoded by the sender and transmitted to the receiver through a medium or channel for consumption. In most cases, the information transmitted is of importance to the receiver. For example, the employer displays a notice stating that employees who arrive late for two consecutive days will be issued a memo. This information is for the consumption of employees therefore, the medium is a written communication in the form of a notice which is displayed on the common board. Information transmission can occur in many directions like it can be transmitted downwards. For instance, in downward moving communication, information is being sent from the top management or a superior to the subordinates. Whereas in the upward moving communication, information is usually transmitted from the subordinates to the top level authority or superiors. In the horizontal moving communication, information flows in the same level i.e. from superior to superior, worker to worker, etc.

Motivation: Another significant function of communication is motivation. For instance, business and political leaders motivate millions of publics with their spoken or written words. It is important to understand that in order to inspire people it is necessary to develop effective communication skills.

Persuasion: Communication is also required to persuade people. For example, during elections, every political party plans and executes persuasive campaigns to attract voters. The catchy phrases repetitively used by the political leaders and political parties play important role in persuading voters to elect them, Even Advertisers use persuasive advertising campaigns to attract consumers. The sole purpose of communication is to influence others; we communicate to influence, to intentionally affect or change the behaviour of other persons. Aristotle implied that the main aim of communication was 'persuasion'. The purpose of influencing another's understanding of the system in some way would be to alter the receiver's general beliefs, understandings, values, orientations, in some desired way.

Integration: The major function of communication at the interpersonal level is that of self-integration or of continuously off-setting any disintegration. Communication is essential in establishing a link between two communities, cultures, nations and individuals. An important function of communication is

to help individuals comprehend each other. Diplomats of two nations communicate with each other to improve ties between the nations. They exchange written correspondence, sign agreements, conduct joint press conferences, issue press statements, meet over dinners etc. Communication is also important to establish and develop linkage between individuals and groups. For example, various international associations and organizations work with different countries towards one cause thereby, linking the entire world.

Entertainment: Communication is the significant source of entertainment. It helps in fighting boredom. For example, playing dumb charades involves non-verbal communication but is entertaining and breaks monotony. In earlier times, group communication through nautanki, puppetry, dance and music programmes, folklore and story-telling were used to keep people entertained. In the present time, social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, Snapchat, Instagram and numerous mobile phone applications help people stay connected and entertained.

Functions of communication are not limited to the above mentioned points. It is vast and covers many other aspects as well. For instance, communication helps in sharing ideas with more than one person. The multiple opinions on a topic help in widening perspectives. Communicating with more than one person can result in a debate or a discussion which facilitates scope for greater exchange of ideas and suggestions. Debates and discussions allow acceptance and rejection of ideas, change in perception is also possible and deeper understanding of the subject is achieved. In a debate or a discussion, reactions are recorded and feedback is generated which enables to and for flow of opinions and information thereby, completing the process of communication.

Furthermore, communication also helps in preserving and promoting the culture. For example, when photographs are transferred from old to new generations, the latter learns about the culture from the visuals. Poetry, literature, dance, music, painting, art, theatre and films play an integral role in promoting culture. Communication also facilitates exchange of cultures. Communication conveys and spreads the cultural values of a group to more and more people. It urges people to preserve, promote and value their culture.

Communication is necessary to establish, develop and maintain human relations. Amicable diplomatic ties with neighbouring states and global powers can be achieved only if effective communication is applied. It is also important for a superior to make the subordinates feel important and required. Therefore, communication is the key to long term relationships. Communication is the foundation for any desired action. Until and unless the sender communicates what is expected of the receiver, the work will never be done. A teacher has to give an assignment to the student and explain how it has to be done only then the student will be able to complete it. Also, if the

teacher fails to give proper deadline and instructions, communication will not be effective.

Communication also helps in simplifying the process of planning policies. Any information which is required for developing effective policies can be procured with effective communication. It also helps in removing all errors and discrepancies. Information collected by communicating can be used for effective decision-making. It also helps in boosting moral and motivating. The main cause of conflict can be resolved by communication. Removal of misunderstandings can create positive environment which will motivate the participants to work harder.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) How does debates and discussions help in shaping a well-informed society?

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2) Briefly discuss the main functions of communication?

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2.4 IMPORTANCE OF COMMUNICATION

The need for communication for a human being is as solid and as basic as the necessity to eat, sleep and live. It is both an individual as well as a social need. Communication can raise aspirations and raise awareness, meet information needs, and reinforce existing beliefs. We all communicate in some form or the other. We communicate to express our happiness, sadness, opinions, etc. We live in a communication age that has made our life not only fast but comfortable too. What we understand from the above paragraphs is that communication is a social procedure of interaction that is an essential aspect of the life of human beings. It includes an exchange or sharing of information, views, opinion, facts, data, idea or an understanding between a sender and a receiver. Communication is important and is required because of

several reasons. The most fundamental reason why humans need to communicate is that human beings are social animals and there is an ardent urge to share and exchange feelings, emotions, information and knowledge. Communication helps in transferring and exchanging information which is of interest and importance to the participants involved. For example, a baby's cry can help in drawing attention to her/his immediate need, an instruction from the parent or teacher can guide the child or student, greeting guests with folded hands in India means welcoming them and nodding head from right to left means a negative response or disappointment.

Communication allows free flow of information between the participants. Free speech is a guaranteed universal right. It allows every individual to impart or receive information on any topic. Free speech plays a predominant role in facilitating equal representation and participation. Any control or check on freedom of speech and expression can hamper communication process. It can lead to misinformation, incomplete information and prejudiced information. It is important to have transparent communication so that both the parties involved can get equal chance to participate in the process and get benefitted. Communication is also necessary for coordination between all the participants involved. For example, in a full-fledged advertising agency, there are five primary departments namely, account planning, creative, client service, production and media buying and scheduling; even though each department has its own role and responsibilities, it is extremely important to have effective communication between them so that there is complete coordination and the desired target is achieved. Poor coordination can lead to an unhappy client.

It is important for a leader to possess effective communication skills. A good leader is identified on the basis of her/his speaking and listening skills, her/his ability to lead, face challenges, motivate and persuade the subordinates. Effective communication skills can improve the overall performance of an organization. To bring out any political, social or cultural change, it is important for the leaders to possess good communication skills. Effective communication skills can explain to the people why the change is desired and how it will help them. Leaders must possess the ability to draft a message that can influence the people and also the skills to deliver the message. A good opinion leader or influencer can be recognised by her/his communication skills. A speaker also has to be sensitive towards the needs of the audience so that they are motivated to accept the change.

Communication plays a significant role not only in personal communication but also in official communication at organizational, national and global levels. New media has facilitated speedy communication channel as a result we live in a connected world and transfer of information between people belonging to diverse identities has become possible. It is only because of easy, cost effective communication channels available today, people are more informed and connected. For example online courses run by various

universities receive enrolment of several individuals from across the globe, people can make sale and purchase sitting at their home. Interaction and exchange of culture, language, entertainment and education has become easy.

2.5 PRINCIPLES OF COMMUNICATION

Following are the principles of communication process —

- **Active Listening:** It is important to pay attention to what is being communicated. Active listening is essential for effective communication. If the listener is engrossed in the inner chatter, a lot of crucial information is lost. Therefore, it is important to pay attention to the sender. It is also disrespectful to not listen to somebody. Listening to partial information can be very dangerous.
- **Trustworthiness:** Communication must be developed on trust and honesty. Mutual respect for both the participants in the communication process is very important. Trust is the foundation of each successful communication. Valid and accurate information helps in trustworthy communication.
- **Authenticity:** It is necessary to maintain the authenticity of the communication message. Inaccuracy, lies, deceit, confusion and incorrectness in the communication process can hamper it. Participants cannot be fooled by incorrect and unauthentic information. The words and body language should be in sync. If the body language is not appropriate, communication will fail.
- **Non Judgemental:** It is not appropriate to judge people as judgments cannot be the foundation to a good and long term relationship. Judging also leads to comparison and complaints. In order to have a successful and effective communication one must refrain from forming immediate judgements based on little knowledge.
- **Value Difference:** It is important to value the contribution of each participant involved in the communication process. Acknowledging the participant's efforts and inputs can create comfortable environment and effortless communication can take place. If the participants are respected and listened to, they will indulge in free and effective communication. Participants must be motivated and encouraged to share their opinions and ideas.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Describe briefly the importance of communication.

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2) What are the principles of communication?

2.6 LET US SUM UP

To sum up, communication plays a vital role in establishing, developing, improving and maintaining relationships to the self, others and the society. Communication is therefore central to the growth, progress and development of an individual, group and society. Communication helps in exchange of ideas and views and helps people to improve their understanding of diverse issues. Communication is an indispensable tool in solving misunderstanding between individuals, groups and countries. Communication helps in developing skills and sensitivities required to build a successful society. Communication helps in improving both personal and professional relationships. Communication also helps in enhancing and improving cross cultural understanding. Communication plays a significant role in all spheres of life. Communication is essential to identify and groom leaders who can take challenges and support the group, institution and society by taking initiatives which will be beneficial for the recipients.

2.7 SUGGESTED READINGS

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2.8 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) Debates and discussions are significant in shaping public opinions by allowing constructive criticisms and acceptance or rejection of ideas. It also helps in bringing in a positive change in perception enabling deeper understanding of the subject.
- 2) The main functions of communication involve surveillance, correlation, informing, motivating, persuasion, cultural promotion, promoting healthy debate and discussion, developing linkages between generations and lastly entertainment to name a few.

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) Communication process is an integral part of human lives. Communication allows free flow of information between individuals that helps not only in shaping opinions but also in making the society aware and well informed. The most fundamental reason why humans need to communicate is that human beings are social animals and there is an ardent urge to share and exchange feelings, emotions, information and knowledge.
- 2) The major principles of communication could include active listening, trustworthiness, authenticity, non-judgement and giving value to differences among the participants. All these factors are required to build up a healthy communication process.

UNIT 3 INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Contents

- 3.0 Aims and Objectives
- 3.1 Introduction
- 3.2 Definition
- 3.3 Process and Elements of Interpersonal Communication
- 3.4 Culture and Interpersonal Communication
- 3.5 Identity and Interpersonal Communication
- 3.6 Language in Interpersonal Communication
- 3.7 Functions of Interpersonal Communication
 - 3.7.1 Functions
- 3.8 Interpersonal Communication and Opinion Leaders
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- 3.10 Interpersonal Strategies to Rural Development
 - 3.10.1 Participatory Rural Appraisal
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 - 3.11.1 National Farm Radio Forum
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- 3.13 Key Words
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3.0 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

After reading this unit, you will be able to:

- Define interpersonal communication;
- Understand the process and elements of interpersonal communication;
- Understand the space of culture, identity and language in interpersonal communication;
- Identify the functions of interpersonal communication; and
- Discuss interpersonal strategies to rural development.

3.1 INTRODUCTION

This unit discusses about definition, process and elements of interpersonal communication, culture and interpersonal communication, identity and interpersonal communication, language in interpersonal communication, functions of interpersonal communication, marriage of interpersonal communication and mass communication, interpersonal strategies to rural development and case studies on interpersonal communication.

3.2 DEFINITION

Needless to say, interpersonal communication is a unique nature of communication. Keval J. Kumar (2011, p. 11) defines interpersonal communication as “direct face-to-face communication between two persons. In other words, it is a dialogue or a conversation without the interventions of another person or a machine like the telephone or a two-way radio or television set up. It is personal, direct, and intimate, allowing for maximum interaction and exchange in word and gesture.”

Interpersonal communication builds the connection between people. Such communication tends to affect people's action and reflect the other. There are three stages of interpersonal communication — phatic stage, personal stage and intimate stage. The phatic stage is all about the initial course of conversation in which people tend to greet each other. This phase of interpersonal communication is a warm up time enables the process of communication. The next stage, the personal stage of interpersonal communication occurs when the participants pour more personal elements to the conversation. It does not refer to always making private topics in public. The last state i.e., the intimate stage of interpersonal communication occurs when the participants are engrossed in communication by breaking the social barriers.

Interpersonal communication has undergone massive changes with the advancements in information and communication technologies. For example, mobile phones and email communication have radically changed the interpersonal communication pattern. Since interpersonal communication is connected with various dimensions, it can be understood in varied contexts. Firstly, interpersonal communication is dynamic in nature. It is in constant motion and often changes keeping the location, climate and atmosphere in mind. Secondly, interpersonal communication is transactional as the participations in the process of communication are engaged in interaction. Thirdly, interpersonal communication is dyadic in nature. You may chat with another or mail to another person who resides in a distant location. Fourthly, interpersonal communication creates and leaves with impact. It tends to change and persuade participants' behaviour and relationship. These dimensions are pervasive while strategizing interpersonal communication for rural development.

3.3 PROCESS AND ELEMENTS OF INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Interpersonal communication enjoys certain kind of features or elements. Interpersonal communication is continuous in nature. It is a dynamic process as the meanings are subjected to change based on the previous messages communicated between the participants. Interpersonal communication happens to be consequential. Such form of communication is goal-oriented and has indeed outcomes. Interpersonal communication occurs in irreversible manner as one cannot take back the messages what has been communicated or transpired. Last not the least, interpersonal communication happens to be imperfect. In such form of communication, one's thoughts can never be fully disseminated to another (Solomon & Theiss, 2012).

The messages in the process of interpersonal communication are unique in nature. In the process of interpersonal communication, there are two types of messages — content and relational — are disseminated. The message is the bedrock of communication. Content messages can be direct or indirect. On the other hand, relational messages lay stress on relationship that occurs between the partners in the process of communication. The relational messages in interpersonal communication attempts to prioritize one person's effort to modify the relationship, maybe for better or worse.

In the context of rural development, if the government wants to send some health related information to a village person through an ASHA worker, then ASHA worker/government is the source/sender, message is on health, face to face communication is the medium, that village person is the receiver; the response/reaction is the feedback. Overall, this is a process of interpersonal communication for rural development.

3.4 CULTURE AND INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

There are certain characteristics of culture. Culture is shared among the members of society. Culture tends to change over a period of time. Culture covers every aspects of life including the way we take food, talk, walk, sleep and our societal relationship. Most interestingly, these get reflected while we communicate with other. In this context, the importance and priority of interpersonal communication experience occupies the most prominence. Culture and interpersonal communication are related to each other. The communication one makes is influenced by one's culture. Cultural norms tend to form and shape your interpersonal experience. The role of cultural behaviour plays an important role in interpersonal communication. Culture moulds the mode of communication. Similarly, communication reflects culture. For example, speech codes are very much part of communication. Usually, the speech codes stem from culture and often reveal one's culture. Therefore, the pattern of interpersonal communication covers the mark of

culture including one's way of behaviour, traditions and rituals. By the virtue of interpersonal skills, traditions and rituals are recognized in a cultural set up. Primarily the space of interpersonal communication elevates and strengthens the cultural norms of a society. At the same time, like any other forms of communication including interpersonal communication, varied forms of traditions and rituals foster or reinforce societal and cultural beliefs.

The central role of culture in shaping interpersonal communication experiences remains significant. When one creates the space for interpersonal communication, one's culture provides ample instructions and guidelines. When there are cultural differences, intercultural communication arises. In this circumstance, people attempt to accommodate their communication in terms of showing solidarity or difference in the process of communication. In this juncture, the role of interpersonal communication or intercultural communication remains pivotal for a harmonized society. Intercultural communication can do its best when the barriers of communication — ethnocentrism, uncertainty and anxiety and marginalization — are kept in mind to overcome these barriers. However, there are ethical issues that tend to influence culture and interpersonal communication. By overcoming the barriers will pave the way for better experience with intercultural communication.

3.5 IDENTITY AND INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

The nature of identity and interpersonal communication are interconnected. Identity shapes up interpersonal communication and vice versa. In course of interpersonal communication, usually a person articulates or reveals his/her personality, objectives and value system to another person. Such type of articulation tends to enrich the essence and form of interpersonal communication. In this context, discussing various layers of identity is of utmost importance. Michael Hecht opines that there are four layers — personal layer, enactment layer, relational layer and communal layer — to identity (Solomon & Theiss, 2012). The personal layer of identity means the perception the people carry about themselves that they tend to communicate with others. The personal layer of identity includes one's self-concept, self-knowledge and perceptions which further decide the topic and future course of interpersonal communication. The enactment layer of identity refers to one's qualities that are articulated in terms of verbal or non-verbal form of communication with another person. The relational layer of identity refers to the characteristics of one person that are essential to build relationship with other people. It tends to influence and shape up the course of interpersonal communication. The communal layer of identity refers to the characteristics of one person that are essential to build his/her group membership. These four layers of identity keep on influencing the process of interpersonal communication.

3.6 LANGUAGE IN INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Language is a tool of interpersonal communication. Usually language is abstract, arbitrary, culturally driven and determined and consequential in manner. It could be verbal or non-verbal communication in nature. Language enables the individuals to share ideas, plan and future course of action which are essential for effective interpersonal communication. Factors like gender, power and intimacy and social contexts influence the level of interpersonal communication. Communication has the dimensions of gender where usually men are factual and prioritize their choice of words and women are emotional in conversation. Studies found that men and women do communicate differently. Power and intimacy come to play in course of interpersonal communication. These two aspects of communication affect the space of conversation between two participants. The interpersonal communication is different in upward communication and horizontal communication in an office because of power relations. It is also the intimacy which decides the kind of language. If the interpersonal relationship is intimacy in nature, then the language becomes informal. Social contexts also influence the language to be used in interpersonal communication. Language is situation bound. When we employ the language in interpersonal communication, we need to follow certain approved norms of language of that particular society.

3.7 FUNCTIONS OF INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

Interpersonal communication articulates both content and relationship information. It can be intentional or unintentional. It is irreversible in nature. It is dynamic in nature. Such type of communication is intertwined with ethics. The function of interpersonal communication is immense in fostering communication for change and development. It has number of functions like gaining information. It facilitates to gain the relevant information; creates a context or situation of understanding; creates an identity; and satisfying the interpersonal needs.

To William Schutz, there are three needs — inclusion, control, and affection — required for interpersonal communication (Em Griffin, 1977). These three needs have different functions. The function or needs of inclusion is to create and maintain identity with other. The need of control is to bring forth leadership qualities which also act as testimonies. Affection enables the individuals to build the appropriate relationship with other individuals. All these needs are required while employing interpersonal communication to frame and execute rural development strategies.

3.7.1 Functions

The dimensions of social interaction pertaining to interpersonal communication

are immense. Social interaction has bearings on influencing individuals for social change and development. Social interaction has the power to influence individuals for social change and rural development. Influence, intimacy, and communicating support and comfort or integration are the key components through which interpersonal communication helps to bring changes and mobilizes overall development in rural regions. The developmental agencies tend to keep these key components in mind while strategizing communication plans for rural development. The face-to-face interaction involves the idea of continuity (Sigman, 1991). Kendon and Ferber (1973) assert that face-to-face communication mobilizes the initiation and termination points. Sometimes it is known as greeting and leave-taking behaviour. Sigman's understanding of face-to-face communication has created an insignificant space in interpersonal communication which can be instrumental for development in particular and rural development in particular.

Interpersonal Influence

Usually goals in terms of knowledge, expectations, and desires motivate or influence interpersonal communication. Moreover, goals tend to enable a communicator to be an effective communicator. Interpersonal influence remains an important factor to achieve interpersonal goals. Interpersonal influence happens anytime when one participant employs messages to influence the other participant's attitude, behavior and action. There are two types of interpersonal goals — primary goals and secondary goals. Based on the primary goals, secondary goals may or may not be required because of interventions of interpersonal influence or communication. Diverse influence goals require diverse amount of interpersonal communication. Based on the goals – primary goals or secondary goals, the required amount of interpersonal communication is warranted. Managing multiple interpersonal goals is often challenged by individuals. Prioritizing the goals is essential. Sometimes it is required to pursue goals in sequential manner. Sometimes it is also required to pursue all the goals simultaneously. Identification of goals required for interpersonal communication remains essential. One should recognize when one experiences the influential goal of one's interpersonal communication.

To derive maximum interpersonal influence, communication pattern needs to be tailored made and contextualized. In this context, crafting the influence messages is vital as it tends to influence the interpersonal behaviour of participants. Planning for interpersonal influence communication is a must. It is better to plan something pragmatic approach in well advance for get harvest maximum communication effectiveness. Overcoming the obstacles in interpersonal influence communication is of paramount importance.

Interpersonal Intimacy

Interpersonal intimacy is one of the functions of interpersonal communication. Interpersonal intimacy is understood as the bond between

two persons, covering the aspects of psychological, emotional, and behavioural ties. As a result, Intimacy is able to provide companionship, entertainment, and support to the individuals. Nature of intimacy determines the level of interpersonal communication. The interpersonal relationship or communication differs from one's friend to mentor. Closeness, openness, trust, affection and mutuality are the integral components of interpersonal intimacy. Intimate friendships or romantic relationships are some of the instances of interpersonal intimacy.

The communication in interpersonal communication or intimate relationships remains dynamic in nature and it keeps on changing. With help of interpersonal communication, intimate relationship helps one to provide and receive help, revitalize one's routine life by managing the stress level. Interpersonal communication is used to maintain intimacy relationship by controlling the relational tensions. In general, such form of communication is able to immensely perform in the direction of maintaining intimacy, strategic maintenance and routine maintenance. People maintain interpersonal relationship through various forms of communication like showing love and commitment, positive, co-enjoying the social networks and managing the tensions or conflicts.

In order to cope with the tension or mitigate the stress and to achieve the state of interpersonal intimacy, it is important to establish close relationships or interpersonal relationships. Some of the coping mechanism are such as ignoring the tension, disorienting the state of helplessness, limited dialogue and spiraling alteration. Pursing a different segmentation of tensions and balancing between the tension and seeking for the stage of compromise, it is essential to calibrate the two sides of the conflict and reaffirmation for the relationship which are vital for building or retaining an interpersonal relationship.

Communicating Support and Comfort or Integration

Communicating support and comfort or integration is one of the functions of interpersonal communication. People have different integration or comforting communication. It could be because of varying contexts and personal traits. Nonverbal support messages and verbal support messages are a lot to do in providing comfort to the participants in interpersonal communication or interpersonal relationships. Participants in communication process can resort to nonverbal behaviour as these are beneficial to distress a situation. Empathy is instrumental in mobilizing nonverbal behaviour. Similarly, verbal messages provide tone, content, and orientation which attempts to provide communication support and comfort to the participants. Here, the messages could be person-centered messages or topics of support messages or mixed of these two. Overall, to provide comforts in interpersonal relationship remains an important function of interpersonal communication.

When it comes to rural development, the space and function of interpersonal communication cannot be replaced with mass communication channels. Interpersonal communication equipped with sheer amount of persuasiveness and credibility is to disseminate the developmental messages and convince the rural audience towards the path of development. Such type of communication has the power which acts as an agent of communication and empowerment through extension activities. Training required for extension workers is much to do with interpersonal communication. It facilitates the participatory nature of involvement among the farmers. Moreover, individual learning among the farmers' communities is also taken care of. Furthermore, UNICEF (2017) has approved the practical utility of interpersonal communication for rural development pertaining to the organizational and policy level. Several developmental initiatives including advocacy and social mobilization are managed by interpersonal communication.

Developmental initiatives are deeply connected with development communication. Whenever there is a discussion on development communication, the role of Information Education and Communication (IEC) materials come to the fore. IEC is a planned effort to meet the defined aims and objectives which mobilize community development including rural development. IEC for rural development can navigate the areas of health, education, occupational structure and overall community participation. For the purpose of development, the governmental bodies like Directorate of Field Publicity, Song & Drama division, State Institutes of Panchayat and Rural Development attempt to maximize interpersonal communication activities. They bank on the power of interpersonal communication for the maximum utility of special campaigns, traditional and folk media and other interactive media.

3.8 INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION AND OPINION LEADERS

Opinion leaders are possessed with number of traits. They have the influence on people's opinions, actions, and behaviours comparatively more than media. They are trusted by the community people. They are better educated than the community people. They have better access to mass media than the community people. They are non-partisans and non-purposive. They have the power to convince and persuade the people. They have the leadership qualities so that community people can follow them. These traits and qualities are important as these parameters have bearings on the effectiveness of interpersonal communication.

The importance of opinion leaders in the age of social media is gaining momentum. Since social media is an open platform, it fosters the sense of communication among the participants. Furthermore, since the opinion leaders are keen to influence others, social networking sites as venues provide fodder for interpersonal communication. Opinion leaders tend to

send personalized messages to particular members of social networking sites in a private form of communication.

When it comes to the use of interpersonal communication for rural development in social networking sites, it can be from individuals, governmental or non-governmental agencies. Opinion leaders who are specialized in various areas of development — health, education, employment — can initiate the interpersonal communication with the relevant stakeholders. Since interpersonal communication is intimate in nature, the opinion leaders can bring empowerment and development for rural development through the discourse of communication. However, the fake conversations or malicious conversation have to be avoided.

3.9 INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION AND MASS COMMUNICATION: THE MARRIAGE OF THE TWO

Every form of communication has its own advantages and disadvantages. Mass communication, as a means of communication, has number of advantages. They communicate for information, education and entertainment. They tend to transmit the cultural norms from a generation to generation. This form of communication can be accomplished to a wide and varied class of audience at a single time with low cost of production per unit. The communication is rapid and on a continuous basis. However, it is suitable in certain circumstances. In certain communication planning, interpersonal communication enjoys certain advantages, especially in the areas of community development focusing on rural development. It enables and facilitates to build and retain the interpersonal relationship which is required for the process of development. It is not possible in case of mass communication process.

Interpersonal communication has the facility of face to face communication which is not possible in case of mass communication channels. When you want to personalize message which is essential in development communication, it can only be possible in case of interpersonal communication, not in mass communication. The messages can be the adoption of newer technologies or hygienic health practice or using high-yielding seeds or choosing an alternative path to occupation.

Interpersonal communication and mass communication have their own advantages and disadvantages. They need to be situationally employed to have the best benefit of communication meant for development. There should be the marriage of interpersonal communication with mass communication. In fact, interpersonal communication and mass communication should be used in a complimentary manner to make the communication strategy effective for rural development.

3.10 INTERPERSONAL STRATEGIES TO RURAL DEVELOPMENT

A communication strategy is designed to communicate the messages effectively and meet the desired objectives. Communication strategy for rural development focuses on objectives, target audience, message, medium of communication/communication channels, timeline, resources and evaluation.

The objectives of communication strategy drive the developmental goals. In case of rural development, it could be communicating on primary healthcare, education or government welfare programmes. Usually, communication strategy attempts to identify the target audience and address their issues or goals. Meeting target audience's requirements is to meet the objectives of the communication strategy. In case of rural development, target audience could be the village communities. Message is the idea or courses of action that a communication strategy intends to disseminate to the target audience. Identifying the stakeholders is of utmost importance.

In case of rural development, message could be on development oriented messages like improving health in rural regions or enhancing the quality of primary education in villages or convincing the villagers for the adoption of newer method of agriculture. Medium or channel of communication entails the routes to which the message can be disseminated from the source to the target audience. Channel of communication could be one or integration of more than one channels. Broadly, the channel of communication could be the print, electronic and digital in nature. It depends upon the nature of target audience and message. Sometimes to disseminate a single message, there could be integration of media channels. Interpersonal communication has its distinctive position and enjoys a privileged position in the communication strategy. In case of rural development, communication strategy may involve interpersonal communication as it tends to personalize the message meant for the rural audience. Illiteracy still persists in rural regions, so the need to integrate interpersonal communication with audio-visual communication becomes effective to reach out to the target audience in rural areas.

Timeline is an important dimension in a communication strategy. The planning, execution and assessment of communication strategy is time bound. If a rural region suffer from waterborne diseases in monsoon season, the communication strategy to sort out the issue in the monsoon season only. Resources or funding remain pivotal in communication strategy. Starting from planning to evaluation, an adequate amount of resources is required for the proper functioning of strategy. The evaluation enables to critically understand the effectiveness of the communication strategy. Based on the evaluation, communication strategy will take its own course. In case of communication for rural development, if the mass communication fails to foster the sense of women empowerment and development, probably

interpersonal communication may be executed for personalized communication from individuals to individuals.

3.10.1 Participatory Rural Appraisal

Participatory rural appraisal (PRA) is an approach which enables the developmental agencies for achieving rural development. The method behind the PRA is to employ the stock of knowledge and opinion of rural people in framing, planning and managing the developmental programmes. The techniques used for PRA include understanding and applying the group dynamics; surveying and sampling; interviewing; and community mapping. In the technique of interviewing, focus group discussions, semi-structured interviews and triangulation have been used. In semi-structured interviews, interpersonal communication occurs in which a rural person tends to unravel the stock of local stock of knowledge and has his/her opinion on developmental project or issues. The face to face interaction occurs, intensifying and navigating several issues to be resolved. This approach enjoys pragmatism, showing a unique way of deliberating on developmental dimensions.

3.10.2 Integrated Communication Strategy

Achieving rural development is tailor-made, not readymade. Each problem in rural areas needs specific communication strategy for redressal mechanism and amicable solutions. Needless to say, there are three types of communication channels – print media, electronic media and digital media. Based on objectives, nature of target audience and developmental issues, medium of communication can be chosen and applied. Sometimes developmental agencies employ more than one medium to make the communication more effective which ultimately fosters development in rural regions. It is called integrated communication strategy. Integrated communication seems more relevant today.

In the context of rural development, integrated communication is more relevant and needs expertise to execute the communication strategy. Understanding the rural areas, rural population, rural issues and rural mindset are important. The level of illiteracy, unemployment and social taboos is still grave. Therefore, deliberation and achievement of rural development still remains a delicate affair. The space of interpersonal communication in integrated communication strategy is immense which fosters positivity in mobilizing behavioural changes and social participation of rural people. Based on the developmental projects, interpersonal communication can be used along with audio-visual communication in order to harvest the maximum utility of communication strategy for rural development.

UNICEF (2017) claims that framing and implementing diverse communication strategies including advocacy, interpersonal communication, infotainment and mass communication have been fruitful for rural development. The diverse communication strategies tend to influence and

mould the community behaviour in rural regions for their active participation in the developmental projects. UNICEF also observes that the role of interpersonal communication in communication for development is ineffective.

Behaviour Change Communication (BCC) is one of the aspects of communication strategy in which potentials of interpersonal communication can be maximally tapped. BCC refers to the strategic use of communication to promote the sectors of health, education and the like through its tailored messages. Integrated communication strategy also fosters social change communication which is multi-dimensional. Mobilizing social change communication requires an appropriate communication strategy in which the use of interpersonal communication is there. In communication strategy, message designing remains crucial. Again, message design for the utilization of interpersonal communication is of utmost importance. Needless to say, the dissemination of message information should be appropriate for rural development. The strategy of planning, implementation and evaluation keep on alert of the message design part.

McCornack (2004) argues a message design could be expressive, conventional and rhetorical in manner. Expressive messages are those which are conveyed by the information source with the other participants. For example, a healthcare developmental professional may convey a message on healthy practice to a citizen through the process of interpersonal communication. The conventional messages lay stress on the achievement of goals. For example, a healthcare developmental professional may brief on the success of governmental health campaign to a citizen. This influences the other participant who is in the process of interpersonal communication. This might lead to the amplification of message to other citizens from a single citizen. So, the conventional messages gain importance in strategizing rural development plans and programmes. Rhetorical messages through interpersonal communication signal the proficiency of communication appropriateness, effectiveness, and ethics. This form of message not only ensures the effectiveness but also directs the moral compass of the communication.

Since there is a huge proliferation of digital communication, communication strategy is undergoing continuous changes. In a similar fashion, the use of interpersonal communication has been changed in a digitalized communication strategy. Since interpersonal communication also happens through technologies, understanding of varied dimensions is of utmost importance for rural development. Digital communication has enabled the human being to communicate with easy and with much faster pace. However, the communication process may get distorted and the desired communication may get derailed. So, many precautionary and preparatory efforts need to be taken.

Firstly, one needs to measure the gravity of the message to the medium of communication. One should know when to use online and which message

should go online or offline. This brings the argument when to make the message online for more effectiveness of the message. Secondly, do not assume or take it granted that mass communications in digital forms are better than offline communication all the time. Thirdly, when you communicate through online, presume that you have larger audience to address and communicate. Fourthly, be cautious of the emotionally features of online interaction. Fifthly, when you are interacting with others through online, communications needs to be careful. Precautionary measures need to be taken to make the communication effective. All these measures can be logical when one intends to do interpersonal communication in digital platforms for rural development.

3.11 CASE STUDIES

3.11.1 National Farm Radio Forum

The National Farm Radio Forum, a weekly radio programme from CBC from 1941 to 1965 to reinforce adult education and community improvements in Canada. Communication was participatory in nature in which rural community was involved in the process of content production. Interpersonal communication was grossly used in this project which was later experimented in India, Ghana and France with the recommendation from UNESCO.

3.11.2 Controlling AIDS

India has been fully committed to 'Ending the AIDS' by 2030 as part of Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Governmental bodies, National AIDS Control Organization (NACO) and other developmental agencies have been attempting to control AIDS and educate the public on AIDS in India. Information Education and Communication (IEC) has been proved fruitful for controlling the infection. NACO has been resorting to the strategy of media mix in which print, electronic and digital form of communication are part of communication strategy. In the communication strategy, interpersonal communication is also part and partial of communication strategy. Under National Rural Health Mission (NHM), Link Worker Scheme (LWS) is addressing the rural HIV infection through interpersonal communication. The tools of interpersonal communication are getting used to develop the target specific Behaviour Change Communication (BCC) package for Targeted Interventions for High Risk Groups (HRGs).

3.11.3 Defending Dignity/Fighting Poverty

With the slogan 'Defending Dignity/Fighting Poverty', CARE Bangladesh project was launched in 1993 to address several developmental issues in rural regions of Bangladesh by using communication strategies. CARE Bangladesh has addressed the issues in the areas of food, nutrition security; climate change and resilience; life free from violence; humanitarian;

women's economic empowerment, inclusive governance; and sexual reproductive and maternal health through strategic communication. These areas have significant bearings on rural development. The adoption of interpersonal tools is a part of strategic communication for attaining the state of rural development in Bangladesh (Bateman, 1995). Intensive interpersonal communication, a part of communication strategies has used innovative games, stories and songs. These innovative mechanisms were developed by the village people themselves. At the completion of the project, the cases of diarrhea had significantly dropped and health conditions of the villagers were substantially improved.

3.11.4 Mewat Community Radio

Mewat Community Radio station situated in Nuh, Haryana attempts to bring social change and development of the rural communities. Its programmes are participatory in nature. In order to communicate effectively to the community people, the community radio has resorted to two-step flow model of communication which accommodates the space of interpersonal communication. It has associated opinion leaders — *panchayat*, *maulvi* and *teachers* — to influence the community people through behaviour change communication. Interpersonal communication infuses community participation which further brings change and development in the community.

3.12 LET US SUM UP

In this unit, we discussed the concept of interpersonal communication and its use in communication strategy for rural development. Interpersonal communication is direct face-to-face communication between two persons. It intends to personalize the message and the acceptance of the message is high. There are three stages of interpersonal communication — phatic stage, personal stage and intimate stage. The space of interpersonal communication in development communication is of utmost significance.

The elements of interpersonal communication comprise sender, receiver, message, channel, noise and feedback. The functions of interpersonal communication are varied in fostering rural development. Theoretical deliberations on interpersonal communication have signaled the linear model of communication and two-step flow of communication model. There is no need to compare interpersonal communication with mass communication, rather to complement with each other in a communication strategy.

Communication strategy is designed to communicate the messages effectively and to meet the desired objectives. Participatory rural appraisal and integrated communication strategy, as part of communication strategy have their own advantages in which interpersonal communication plays an important role. The case studies highlighted reveal that interpersonal communication employed for the rural audience have a positive impact in rural society.

The current unit restricts itself in describing the definition and functions of interpersonal communication, its use for rural development and a part of communication strategy by employing certain case studies.

3.13 KEY WORDS

Interpersonal Communication: This term is used to denote face to face communication. Interpersonal communication has undergone massive changes with the advancements in information and communication technologies. There are three stages of interpersonal communication — phatic stage, personal stage and intimate stage. It tends to change and persuade participants' behaviour and relationships. These dimensions are pervasive while strategizing interpersonal communication for rural development.

Opinion Leaders: This term is used for the dissemination the information with their interpretation of information in addition to the actual facts in the media contents. The public follow the opinion leaders are known as opinion followers. These opinion leaders are positioned as opposed to the so-called mainstream mass media which have enormous power and influence on the public. Usually developmental agencies employ opinion leaders in disseminating messages in rural societies.

Communication Strategy: This term is used for communicating the message effectively and to meet the desired objectives. The objectives of communication strategy drive the developmental goals. They tend to ensure communication strategy. In case of rural development, it could be communicating on primary healthcare, education or government welfare programmes or the adoption of improved method of farming.

Culture: The term is used to mention various facet of culture. Culture is shared among the members of society. Culture tends to change over a period of time. Culture covers every aspects of life including the way we take food, talk, walk, sleep and our societal relationship. Most interestingly, these get reflected while we communicate with other.

Identity: The term is used to describe the meaning of identity in the context of culture and interpersonal communication. The nature of identity and interpersonal communication are interconnected. Identity shapes up interpersonal communication and vice versa.

Interpersonal Influence: The term is used as an important factor to achieve interpersonal goals. Interpersonal influence happens anytime when one participant employs messages to influence the other participant's attitude, behaviour and action. One should recognize when one experiences the influential goal of one's interpersonal communication.

Interpersonal Intimacy: The term is used as one of the functions of interpersonal communication. Interpersonal intimacy is understood as the

bond between two persons, covering the aspects of psychological, emotional, and behavioural ties.

Communicating Support: The term is used as one of the functions of interpersonal communication. People have different integration or comforting communication. It could be because of varying contexts and personal traits. Nonverbal support messages and verbal support messages are a lot to do in providing comfort to the participants in interpersonal communication or interpersonal relationships.

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UNIT 4 ELECTRONIC MEDIA AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Structure

- 4.0 Aims and Objectives
- 4.1 Introduction
- 4.2 Role of Electronic Media
 - 4.2.1 Types of Electronic Media
 - 4.2.2 Classification of Electronic Media
 - 4.2.3 Applications and Uses of Electronic Media
- 4.3 Electronic Media in Rural Development
 - 4.3.1 Case Studies
 - 4.3.2 Implications for Development
- 4.4 Let Us Sum Up

4.0 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

After having gone through this unit, you should be able to:

- Explain the need for electronic media in education and communication;
- List the attributes of the electronic media;
- Explain the types of electronic media; and
- Understand the role of electronic media applications in rural development.

4.1 INTRODUCTION

This Unit is aimed at acquainting students with the importance of electronic media and its role and contributions for Rural Development. The objective is to familiarize students about the potential of electronic media that may be used for developmental purpose. The focus is on various types of electronic media which are low cost, participatory and interactive. The students will also be made aware of the role of electronic media as a tool for development communication. Electronic media applications will also be explained through case studies.

4.2 ROLE OF ELECTRONIC MEDIA

Electronic media is a significant force in facilitating development. The messages propagated through electronic media are governed by instantaneity and simultaneity. These two terms refer to message as instant in nature and reaches simultaneously to all at the same time. Rapid communication through latest media technologies has facilitated speedy information gathering and dissemination and this has become an essential part of the

modern society. It was Marshall McLuhan who said that electronic technology is reshaping and restructuring patterns of social interdependence and every aspect of our personal life. Extraordinary information explosion have dramatically shrunk time and distance and have converted our world into a Global Village. Electronic media have transformed communication and our ability to share, store and gain information and knowledge. The widely available media services are changing the ways in which we live and work and also altering our perceptions and beliefs. It is essential that we understand these changes and effects in order to develop our electronic resources for the benefit of society.

The electronic media has abolished distances and time in disseminating the information, events and ideas. People's access to information has become easy and universal. External control of information flows has become more difficult. Information exchange has come cheaper and simple. It has become easy to have two-way interaction and exchange of ideas. Wide reach and low reception costs encourage centralized information dissemination.

Communications technology is not an end in itself, but rather a means of supplying and preserving information and content. The satellite and web technologies have enhanced the capacity of the electronic media to fulfill their role in producing, gathering and distributing diverse quality content to meet the political, social and cultural needs of all societies, both in developed and developing countries.

Various attempts have been made to exploit the potential of mass media for development purposes from the early stages of the introduction of the media in India. The history of development communication in India can be traced to 1940's when radio broadcast was done in different languages to promote development communication through various programmes, like — Programmes for Rural Audience, Educational Programmes and Family Welfare Programmes. Today television in our country is also used as a medium for social education, weapon against ignorance and awareness among the people, through is difference programmes like Educational Television (ETV), Countrywide Classroom (CWC), Teleconferencing etc. Experiments in Satellite technology has been conducted in recent years to bring about Social change and development. This has been done in the form of SITE Programme and Kheda Communication Projects.

New Technologies have also been put to constructive use for development communication. New technologies like mobile, website and internet are interactive in nature. Interactivity, instant feedback and persuasion capability are used to rope in common person into the process of development. Today government has different websites and call centers that provide instant information or answers queries to questions of development.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Write three characteristics of electronic media.

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2) Define electronic media.

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4.2.1 Types of Electronic Media

Electronic channels range from the electronic mail (email) to television and from the telephone to videoconferencing. When Samuel Morse invented the telegraph in 1835, no one imagined that electronic communication systems would have such a pervasive impact on the way people send and receive information. In general, electronic channels serve as *transducers* for written and oral communication. Television converts oral and visual images into electronic signals for sending and then back into oral and visual images at the receiver's end.

Electronic channels usually have the same basic characteristics as the other channels, but electronic media exert their own influence. The most obvious of these are speed and reach. Electronic channels cover more distance more quickly than is possible with traditional means of conveying information. The speed and reach of electronic channels create new expectations for both sender and receiver, and while the fundamental characteristics of oral and written communication remain, the perceptions of electronic messages are different from those of their traditional equivalents.

The advent of electronic communication channels created an awareness of whether communication was *synchronous* or *asynchronous*. Synchronous communication requires both the sender and the receiver to be available at the same time. Face-to-face meetings, telephone conversations, "live" radio and television (most talk shows, sporting events, and anything else not prerecorded), videoconferencing, and electronic "chat rooms" are all examples of *synchronous* communication. Letters and other printed

documents, electronic mail, electronic conferences, voice mail, and pre-recorded video are all examples of *asynchronous* communication.

4.2.2 Classification of Electronic Media

Mass media are those channels of communication which can expose large numbers of people to the same information at the same time. They include media which convey information by sound (radio, audio cassettes); moving pictures (television, film, video); and print (posters, newspapers, leaflets). The attraction of mass media to extension services is the high speed and low cost with which information can be communicated to people over a wide area. Although the cost of producing and transmitting a radio programme may seem high, when that cost is divided between the millions of people who may hear the programme, it is in fact a very cheap way of providing information. The cost of an hour's radio broadcast per farmer who listens can be less than one-hundredth of the cost of an hour's contact with an extension agent.

Radio

Radio is by far the most widely used electronic (mass) medium in rural regions primarily because of its versatility which allows for its use in various types of communication efforts (Mowlana and Wilson, 1990; pp. 151-158). The presence of local radio stations and the availability of small transistor radios allow for 'easy and affordable access' in relatively large geographical areas. The extent to which local radio stations operate as independent broadcasters largely depends on the socio-political and economic context of a country, which also determine the way radio stations are allowed to be used (Heeks, 1999; pp. 3-4).

Local radio stations can be considered the most important mass media as far as their contribution to rural development in developing countries is concerned. The role of these radio stations consists of providing an alternative, more independent, source of general information, as well as offering information on issues of local interest through discussions, interviews with representatives of local interest groups, and testimonies of individuals on their experiences (FAO, 1998, p. 6). Simultaneously they offer local NGOs and government agencies access to mass media and often serve as intermediaries between the population and local authorities.

Radio is by far the most widely used electronic (mass) medium in rural regions primarily because of its versatility which allows for its use in various types of communication efforts. The terms rural radio and community radio have come to be used interchangeably to describe FM stations established to broadcast to a local and predominantly rural audience. The growth of rural radio stations over the past few decades reflects both the improvements in information technologies and the shifting development paradigm towards a more participatory style of information and knowledge transfer. The

‘community’ aspect of local radio initiatives combines a number of approaches.

The most obvious is that a local radio station gives the community a voice, and by encouraging the active participation of the audience in the making and scheduling of programmes this voice can play an empowering and potentially uniting function. The community focus can also serve another function: by employing members of the community both as station staff, such as radio presenters, correspondents and programme facilitators or animateurs, and as intellectual resources, for example providing programme material and content. This not only reinforces the participatory nature of the development approach but ensures local ownership and a greater chance of sustainability. Therefore, although the terms rural and community are used interchangeably it is the community element which has been a deliberate focus of many initiatives to ensure that the stations are run not only for the community but by the community.

Rural radio has other elements: a development focus and an elevated cost per listener compared with urban stations which often make subsidy inevitable. Advertising, as opposed to public service announcements, is often uneconomic. Rural radio is the focus of this paper because the predominantly agricultural audiences of these stations can benefit from information to improve their livelihoods.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What are the different types of electronic media?

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2) What are the characteristics of Radio?

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4.2.3 Applications of Electronic Media in Development

Since the beginning of radio broadcast, radio was considered an innovation and was applied in the various forms for the benefit of rural people. Radio

was utilized in the form of broadcasting which targeted exclusively farmers, villagers, school children other sections of rural areas. Some of the areas in which radio was used are mentioned below:

Rural Broadcasts

In India, radio broadcasting started as far back as 1927. All India Radio started specialized unit called farm and Home until in 1966 to cater to the rural audience. Rural programmes were broadcast by all stations in local dialects. The programmes include hard core technical recommendations, field-based programmes covering festivals, meeting, functions, etc. And interview, recording of folk music, songs, agricultural quiz, sport announcements and documentaries. Many different types of programmes have been tried successfully for providing information in manner like farm School or Air and Mike in the village.

Farm School on Air

Farm School on Air was broadcast from many stations having farm and home units. This was a novel programme in collaboration with state Department of Agriculture and State Agriculture University. All India Radio developed strategy to deliver farm information systematically to farmers in far flung rural areas. Literate with access to radio and evidence of interest and influence in agriculture were selected with the help of the State Department of Agriculture. These farmers were supposed to serve as opinion leader for disseminating scientific information to average farmers. Programmes were divided into lessons. Experts were selected to present the programmes in slow pace by repeating the key points at the end of each programme questions were broadcasts. The listeners were encouraged to send their doubts and questions. Tests were also conducted and registered farmers received certificates.

Field- based Programmes

Studies have indicated that farmers like to hear progressive farmers and known experts. Local fairs, festivals and events attract them. Folk music and songs add local flavor. Programmes recorded outside are preferred than those produced in studio. It is generally suggested to keep 70% studio based programmes. Agriculture information needs to be synchronized with the activities being taken up in the field. Rural broadcaster must have empathy for the woes of the listeners in order to locate appropriate sites, festivals, talents, etc. Which can add local flavour and make programmes interesting? Rural broadcasts can be energized by creative use of folk songs and stories to convey developmental messages.

Radio Drama

It has been found that dramatic presentations of even technical information attract farmers. Dramatic programmes have been tried successfully in Nepal. The programme 'Budi Ama and JTA' featuring two characters old lady and

JTA (grassroots extension worker) provided information on farm problems in interesting manner. In each episode the old lady began with her farm and home problem and the extension worker in a bid to ease out her problem, narrated the solution. This was liked by farmers and the programme ran several years.

Programmes with Local Bias

Farm broadcasts must have precise and locally relevant message. Radio programmes should be synchronized with the timings of agriculture operations and programmes of agriculture development being implemented by the state. This will link farmers with ongoing development efforts. It has been reported that Radio DZLB situated in the University of Philippines at Las Banos aired programmes with information about certain seed developed by International Rice Research Institute (IRRI) in the morning and farmers started enquiring about the supply by the afternoon. Thus, need-based situation-specific broadcast have appealed.

Rural Radio Forum

Rural Radio Forums also known as Charcha Mandals were created in India and several other countries. These forums comprise of the local discussion group organized which are organized by the development worker. Community listening and discussion are encouraged with the help of extension worker. Community radio sets are provided for group listening. Advance information is provided about programmes to be broadcast and the group discusses the programme. Farmer reactions on relevance of the topic, difficulties in listening, queries, etc. are recorded by the extension workers. Such feedbacks are sent to the radio station for modifications in programmes. Thus, the lacuna of the programmes are fed back to the radio station. Extension workers may also record useful programmes of current importance on audio tape. This can be supported by extension literature of local relevance. Audio tapes can be played with the village group at convenient time and discussions can be organized.

Community Radio

Community radio has emerged as a viable and trustworthy alternative to mainstream media in the rural areas, linking various communities of rural India and covering more than local news and entertainment. It is a medium that has kept our ethnic languages and cultures alive daily in the far-flung hamlets and villages of rural India. Community radio is the common link which binds all these development factors over a common communication channel.

A local radio station serves a small area like a district with similar agro-climatic and cultural situations. The programmes are supposed to reflect local culture and aspirations. They are supposed to support on-going developmental programmes. Field-based programmes using local talents,

give voice to people's views. Local culture finds more air time. Community service programmes should provide opportunity to people, their organization an development organization to broadcast matters or information. Radio thus becomes voice of the people and catalyst in development. Unlike regular radio, extension workers can find air time.

Community radio adopts two distinct approaches in its broadcast, not necessarily mutually exclusive. While one stresses what the station can do for the community, mostly information based, the other involves listener participation. The earliest pioneers of community radio in rural areas were the University channels which played a vital role in binding the rural communities through their various rural oriented programmes.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Write three features of farm school on the air.

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2) What are the functions of Radio Rural Forum?

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Use of Radio in Extension Work

Rural Radio Forum (*Churha Mandal*) is a local discussion group organized by development worker. Community listening and discussion are encouraged with the help of extension worker. Community radio sets are provided for group listening. Advance information is provided about programmes to be broadcast and the group discusses the programme. Farmer reactions on relevance of the topic, difficulties in listening, queries, etc. are recorded by the extension workers. Such feedbacks are sent to the radio station for modifications in programmes. Thus, the lacuna of the programmes are fed back to the radio station. Extension workers may also record useful programmes of current importance on audio tape. This can be supported by

extension literature of local relevance. Audio tapes can be played with the village group at convenient time and discussions can be organized.

Community Radio

Looking to the popularity of radio as medium of communication and its effectiveness in development, All India Radio (AIR) ventured into a new phase of broadcasting by experimenting with the concept of local radio station. A local radio station serves a small area (a district or so) with similar agro-climatic and cultural situations. The programmes are supposed to reflect local culture and aspirations. They are supposed to support on-going developmental programmes. Field-based programmes using local talents, give voice to people's views. Local culture finds more air time. Community service programmes should provide opportunity to people, their organization and development organization to broadcast matters or information. Radio thus becomes voice of the people and catalyst in development. Unlike regular radio, extension workers can find air time.

Community Radio Service for Farmers

Community radio is known by many names local radio, alternative radio, independent or free radio. It is a decentralized medium for a limited population of homogenous characteristics. A community consists of contiguous geographical area with 'we' feeling. Community Radio Service (CRS) is basically non-commercial people — centered and developmental in nature. The primordial condition for a community to start its own radio station is a sense of internal cohesion and community consciousness. The type of radio which is by the people and for the people in true sense of the term. The Community radio is based on the need of the people and their involvement in planning and broadcasting. Communication radio is seen as opportunity to give voice to the woes and struggles of rural communities. It is a common knowledge that commercial broadcast has their obsessions with entertainment and programmes which will bring more and more revenue. They are overshadowed by cheap entertainment and commercial interests. Thus, the needs of the isolated areas are not served by private media. Community radio is viable alternative to mass communication to bring remote rural areas into the main stream of national and international economy through informal interaction around the need and experiences of the people in their own language without any external interferences. CRS has been taken as a solution to myriad problems of communication with the poor and the marginalized.

Experiments with rural radio by the FAO began in the late 1960s and by 1969 a Development Support Communication branch had been established within the Information Division to assist with its field activities (Coldevin, 2000). The FAO-funded rural radio stations that broadcast in local languages were initially managed centrally like those state radios run from urban capitals such as Ouagadougou and Bamako (Querre, 1992) and developed in the '90s

into more participatory community-based radio stations (Ilboudo, 2000; Fardon and Furniss, 2000). One such community approach was to use 'narrowcasting' technology based on a community audio tower system (CATS), which used karaoke equipment and an amplifier with microphones in a studio linked to a metallic tower with all-weather loudspeakers.

Television and Video

Television began in India in 1959 as an educational project supported by the United Nations Educational Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO) and the Ford Foundation. Television was based on the model of a public broadcasting system prevalent in many countries of Europe. In independent India, the political leaders recognised the value of information and its use for accelerating the process of development. Thus was started a model of public broadcasting committed to inform, educate and entertain the people.

Television, like film, combines vision with sound and like radio, it can also be an instant medium, transmitting information directly to a mass audience. Television signals can be broadcast from a land-based transmitter, by satellite or through cables. However, in many countries, television transmission and sets are still restricted to urban areas, and the potential of television for rural extension will remain low until sets become more widely available. Television sets are much more expensive to buy and repair than radios, and programme production costs are also far higher. Where television has been used for rural extension communication, access and impact have been increased by group viewing followed by discussion.

Video combines most of the advantages of film and of audio cassettes. Using a video camera, picture and sound are recorded on a magnetic tape and are then immediately available for viewing on a monitor or television set. This enables the production team to re-record any material that is not satisfactory. As with audio cassettes, unwanted information can be removed and the tape reused.

As a mass medium, video has more to offer than film, since video programmes can be made far more quickly in multiple copies, and the lightweight video cassettes are relatively easy to distribute. As video equipment — television monitors and video cassette recorders — becomes more robust, it will be possible to use mobile units to show up-to-date programmes, made within the country and even within the area, to large numbers of rural families. The tape can be slowed down, wound back to repeat a particular action, or held on a particular frame while the extension agent explains a point. The same mobile units could carry portable video cameras to collect material for new programmes. The main limitation to viewing is that only 20 to 30 people can satisfactorily watch a video programme on a normal television set, while several hundred can see a film projected on to a large screen.

Where video equipment is available — and it will become increasingly so over the next few years — extension agents should refer to the guidelines given above for using film and audio cassettes.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What are the characteristics of community radio?

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2) Write features of community radio for farmers.

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SITE experience

The efficacy of television as an electronic medium was highlighted in India with the launch of the satellite Instructional Television Experiment in 1975-76. It was a one year pilot-project using the National Aeronautics and Space Administration's ATS-6 satellite to broadcast educational messages through satellite to 2400 villages in the six states of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Bihar, Orissa, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh. Its objectives were to improve rural primary education, provide teacher training, improve agriculture, health and hygiene, and nutritional practices and contribute to family planning and national integration (Singhal and Rogers, 2001). SITE was "an unqualified success in terms of hardware but the software wasn't specific enough to the area and audience in content or language, and therefore was not so useful and comprehensible" (Joshi, 1985, p. 32).

Recognising its contribution, UNESCO noted, "Kheda was an exceptional example of the combining of modern technologies with a participatory approach to communication. The project employed traditional cultural expressions of a rural community in the creation of its audiovisual programmes, while using modern evaluation techniques for its programme planning. Overall, this project proved to be a good example of the applications of communication for the promotion of human development, particularly of the rural poor, women and children" (UNESCO website, 2011, para. 14). Despite being such a success, the Kheda Project was carried out in splendid isolation from the mainstream and its lessons were not allowed to

influence the development and programme trajectory adopted by Doordarshan (Thomas, 2010).

Internet

The Internet offers various useful tools for communication, among which we might mention electronic mail, the World Wide Web, newsgroups, remote access, file transfer and text-based and voiced-based chat. The net has become the most important e-mail system in the world because it connects so many people worldwide, creating a productivity gain. Organizations use it to facilitate communication between employees and offices, and to communicate with customers and suppliers. Friends and family use e-mail in replacement to snail mail, due to its speed and flexibility. Information retrieval is the second basic Internet function. Many use the Internet to locate and download some of the free, quality computer software that has been made available by developers on computers all over the world.

Web (Internet) based rural portals

Web portals are digital platforms that provide organised gateways to information or act as aggregators of knowledge from various stakeholders. Hosting portals to meet the needs of farmers, extensionists, and other EAS actors needs to be well-thought-out. Some principles of hosting web portals are:

Usability and utility: The portal should be user-friendly to non-experts in information technology (IT). The information provided should be relevant and of high utility to potential users. Local language or multiple language display options also help.

Content organization: Enhance the user experience by presenting the content in a form that is easily understandable, navigable, and searchable, in addition to being visually appealing.

Flexibility: The web portal needs to be flexible in design so that new features can be added when needed without major disturbance to the configuration.

Structure: The structure of the content should be well-defined and in a definite pattern to make access and navigation easier. The site navigation should be easy to locate.

Site display: The portal should preferably work and display consistently across all browsers and devices.

Visualisation: Visualisation of the content repositories can reduce information overload and the time needed to retrieve information.

Customisation: Allowing users to customise the portal to meet their specific needs can increase user satisfaction and efficiency of use. But, for novice users, the majority of information should be displayed in easy to access links.

Content Management System: A CMS enables interactivity so that users can easily upload and update content, which helps increase the repository of information. (1) Features like discussion forums, opinion polls, page rating, live search, surveys, feedback form, and so on encourage interactivity.

Broad-based information: Varied information related to all aspects of rural life, with multimedia content support, helps make the information easy to understand.

Web portals collate the huge amount of knowledge available on the web in a single place. But in spite of the advantages, many people are not yet using web portals due to lack of literacy or awareness. There are also many challenges to be overcome at the organisational and institutional level in order to increase the use of web portals in agriculture.

These portals can serve as a ready reference of information when needed for extension educators, researchers, academics, and policy-makers; however for farmers, literacy is important. Lack of device availability for access is a big drawback, especially for women.

Device compatibility is a very important feature that needs to be recognized during web portal development, mainly because of the mobile phone revolution in rural areas. Integration of features that enable interaction among users and real-time information display for market prices, weather, etc. can be very helpful for farmers. Farmers not only need a device to access the portal, but also the wider infrastructure such as roads, electricity, etc. to actually put the information gained into use. At the organisational level, transparency in information sharing is an important aspect in quality control of information shared. Farmers not only need a device to access the portal, but also the wider infrastructure such as roads, electricity, etc. to actually put the information gained into use. At the organisational level, transparency in information sharing is an important aspect in quality control of information shared.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Name different types of internet based rural portals.

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2) What are the key features of internet based portals?

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4.3 ELECTRONIC MEDIA IN RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Electronic media like applications of radio and television technology through internet technology has revolutionized the areas of education and development. These media have been used in the context of development, which can also be termed as development communication.

Thus, when we refer to *development communication*, it is about such communication that can be used for development. It is about using communication to change or improve the way of living of the citizen of a country. Here we use different types of messages to change the socio-economic condition of people. These messages are designed to transform the behaviour of people for improving their quality of life.

4.3.1 Case Studies

FAO supported Radio Campaign

The radio slots were used strategically to advertise the key messages of the campaign and target particular listeners' groups.

FAO campaign in Malaysia

The campaign in Malaysia, in collaboration with the FAO's Inter-Country Programme on Integrated Pest Management in Rice in South and South-East Asia focused on rat control. Based on a survey to find out the extent of the problem and focus Group Discussions on approaches being used to tackle the problem, the campaign began in 1985 with a series of training workshops for the core group responsible for the management of the SEC.

The multimedia materials were then designed and tested with specific strategies and channels of delivery chosen to have the maximum impact. The radio in this case was used to discourage the use of a particular poison, zinc phosphide, in preference to a safer wax and dust poison, easier to use and more effective. This was followed up with a portable flip chart and booklets used by trainers for physical control methods and group discussion, including religious leaders' sermons. A follow-up evaluation in 1987 showed that the number of farmers using zinc phosphide fell from 92% to 40% and the

number of farmers reporting total damage from rats fell from 47% to 28%. The use of the alternative poison dust and baits recommended by the campaign rose from 14% to 58% and 31% to 94% respectively.

FAO supported Radio Project

One of the difficulties of operating a schedule of agricultural extension programmes on rural radio is accessing agricultural research material to support the range of topics requested by farmers. The International Service for National Agricultural Research (ISNAR) aims to improve the linkages between agricultural research and rural radio in Ghana, Mali, Uganda and Cameroon in a collaborative project with the University of Guelph and FAO. The Developing Countries Farm Radio Network (DCFRN), a Canadian NGO, is also a partner in the project which helps community radio broadcasters to share their experiences and provides training in scriptwriting. Agricultural researchers and radio broadcasters are being brought together to improve the planning, preparation, format and evaluation of their extension programmes. The collaboration between a wide range of partners involved in farm radio broadcasting is intended to be a capacity-building exercise which will provide the stations with additional tools to improve the impact of their programmes (Hambly Odame and Kassam, 2002). The FAO is also collaborating with the World Association of Community Broadcasters (AMARC) to develop training programmes for community radio broadcasters (Ilboudo, 2001).

The international NGO, PANOS, maintains a database of radio programme materials obtainable on cassette or via the internet for community radio stations to use directly or translate and assimilate into local programmes. UNESCO and Danida helped to set up small networks such as the Tambuli network of 20 community radio stations in the Philippines in the 1990s. Providing communication between remote stations and wider networks is often the greatest challenge (Dagron, 2001). Mytton (2000) points towards the future of satellite-based networks and the potential of digital audio broadcasting (DAB) which is already a reality in many developing countries. Apart from reaching the many rural areas that are not served by rural radio due to the lack of a terrestrial FM network, satellite-delivered digital radio can be used to provide large quantities of programme material to existing stations relatively cheaply. The use of the internet as a networking tool is being tested by the FAO both for rural radio and for extension services more generally such as through the Farmnet and Vercon concepts (FAO, 2000a,b)

Apart from the national network, GBC, other radio stations, especially in the regions, devote considerable air time to agricultural topics. One of the early examples of using rural radio for agricultural extension was the Wonsuom project. This was a grassroots development communication project in Swedru District, managed by the University of Ghana Communication Department and funded by UNESCO, started in 1983 (Obeng Quaidoo, 1988). The project covered 18 villages and towns with a combined population of 90,000.

According to 2000 estimates, Ghana has 18 FM and three short wave radio stations, with a total of about 4.4 million radios in use. This means that a sizable part of the population (currently 18.5 million) is exposed to radio broadcasts daily. Vernacular radio also exists in large urban centres in the south, but these are commercial stations which do not necessarily see rural development as their mission.

4.3.2 Implications for Development

Policy issues related to Rural radio has developed over the years into a well established tool for both community empowerment and improving the information and communication capacity of remote rural populations. The developmental potential of rural radio is recognised by international organisations, NGOs and governments alike through a wide array of sectoral foci. Efforts to improve the transfer of knowledge for agricultural development have been concentrated for some time on improving the information interface between researchers, extension agents and farmers. The experience of the vernacular radio programmes on soil and water conservation described above illustrates the type of interaction which can be achieved with farmers living in remote rural communities through the use of carefully designed content. In an era of rapidly developing information and communication technologies rural radio is a powerful mechanism for linking old and new technologies, providing information resources cheaply to those who need them most to improve their livelihoods, whilst at the same time strengthening existing resources of knowledge, enterprise and cultural identity.

Changes in the structure of agricultural extension services worldwide have led to an increased emphasis on demand-driven, participatory and pluralistic mechanisms of information and technology transfer. Extension services are increasingly expected to encourage and facilitate farmer experimentation and enquiry. This corresponds to a shift towards more democratic and decentralised government frameworks within which private sector and market based service delivery mechanisms can operate.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space below for you answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What are the FAO supported radio projects for development?

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2) Write key characteristics of radio projects for development.

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4.4 LET US SUM UP

Electronic media have played an important role as a tool for development communication. It has two primary roles, i.e. Transforming role, as it steps social change in the direction of the hygiene taste of today's generation in this competitive market and a socializing role by seeking to maintain some of the established values of the society. Everett Rogers "Development communication refers to the uses to which communication are put in order to further development." It can thus be said to be an approach to communication which provides communities with information they can use in bettering their lives.

Various electronic media like radio, television were instrumental in transforming communities through development. The evidence can be drawn from several experiments like Radio Rural Forums, Farm School on Air, Field based programmes, Community Radio service for farmers. FAO supported Radio projects. These projects contributed in different areas of development mainly focusing on farm communities. Television is also an effective medium for development. The Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE) experiment Combined with satellite technology, television technology was used for transmitting messages among rural communities. Experiments in Satellite technology, the SITE experiment were conducted in 1975-76 to prove the efficacy of community television for bringing Social change and development. The efficacy of these projects has further increased by integration of internet based technologies. Mobile based apps are an example of miniaturization of electronic technologies.

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